

Iran War Risk

Pillar Report

Middle East Conflict Risk — Researched, Scored, and Personally Committed

Originally written June 19, 2026; scores committed by me June 19, 2026. Fully re-researched July 8, 13, 18, 25, and 30, 2026, and again as a full weekly refresh on August 8, 2026 (P cut at 1mo/3mo, 24/31/41/56/77 → 20/28/41/56/77, committed and stamped by Alex, last COMMITTED baseline). The Aug 16-22 gap saw four abandoned drafts: Aug 17 (held flat), Aug 18 (cut to 17/25/38/54/76), Aug 20 (cut to 16/24/38/54/76, left for manual review over a UAE missile claim), and Aug 21 (a session got partway through delivering the Aug 20 numbers — 2 of 6 reports touched, no render/selfcheck/archive/commit — before stopping). None were rendered, archived, or committed. An Aug 22 morning catch-up cycle (score set **2026-08-22_draft**) independently re-verified the gap via four parallel primary-source research passes, then adversarially fact-checked the load-bearing new claims before delivery — a step that caught a real error (see below) — and cut P to 14/22/38/54/76, delivered as a draft flagged for manual review. **Correction #1 (confirmed accurate):** the UAE missile-attack claim (Aug 18) remains single-source (UAE MoD only, Iran denies and calls it a possible “false flag”) and was NOT the first direct attack on the UAE as prior drafts framed it — UAE was hit by a missile/drone barrage Apr 1-8 and again at its Fujairah port May 4, both Iran-attributed by UAE’s own government and predating Aug 18; that “novel escalation vector” framing is retired. **Correction #2 (a genuine miss, caught on adversarial re-check):** that draft initially described a fatal strike on the bulker Minoan Dignity (chief engineer killed, Aug 17-18) as “the first confirmed fatality” in the Hormuz tanker campaign — that is FALSE; it is one of a cumulative toll of seafarer deaths since the campaign began late February 2026 this report never previously surfaced or scored on. The Iranian vessel seizure (tanker Amara, held near Qeshm Island since Aug 17, first since June 22) IS confirmed accurate. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-22_draft2) is a separate, later-in-the-day FULL WEEKLY refresh** — the first deep multi-source dive since Aug 8 — that independently re-researched the pillar and ran a second, dedicated adversarial-verification pass specifically re-checking (a) whether the casualty-toll figure holds up and (b) whether anything was missed Aug 19-22. It holds up, but softer than a clean number: cross-checking Wikipedia’s “2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis” infobox (18 total), a mid-July gCaptain snapshot (“at least 15”), and IMO’s own incident tracker (19 seafarer deaths, but scoped to the broader Middle East, not Hormuz cleanly) puts the honest range at **15-19 cumulative deaths (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers)**, not a flat “18th death” — that softened framing is carried everywhere below. A UAE missile-attack claim the adversarial pass initially flagged as a possible miss turned out, on reconciliation, to be the same Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline, not a second incident. No new kinetic incident was found Aug 19-22. **P HELD FLAT this cycle at 14/22/38/54/76 — left as draft at delivery (full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from auto-stamp), then reviewed and COMMITTED BY ALEX on August 23** after independent re-verification of the math and the research trail; see My Decision below. A daily catch-up draft dated August 28, 2026 (score set **2026-08-28_draft**) re-checked two more Hormuz tanker incidents and a single-source Iran-Oman revenue-sharing claim, holding P flat — but that draft was never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed, and is treated as abandoned/superseded, the same discipline this report has applied to every other interrupted session (Aug 17, 18, 20, and 21). **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-29_draft) is a NEW, independent FULL WEEKLY refresh** against the last committed baseline (2026-08-22_draft2) — the first cycle in several weeks to surface a genuinely two-sided evidence ledger: a confirmed, crypto-specific sanctions escalation (the Aug 24 “Operation Economic Outcast” package, the first Iran sanctions action to explicitly name digital assets as a sanctionable sector and list 30 on-chain addresses, confirmed via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov) against a confirmed de-escalation upgrade (Oman’s own Foreign Ministry, not just Iran, co-confirming a temporary Hormuz corridor Aug 25, confirmed via direct fetch of fm.gov.om). The two roughly offset, alongside a first-of-the-crisis Hormuz transit uptick and a second straight weekly Brent decline on the bull side, and two more tanker incidents plus a firmer casualty count on the bear side. **P HELD FLAT at 14/22/38/54/76 — left as a draft, not auto-stamped**, because this is a full weekly refresh, categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size (here, zero). See My Decision below. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-08-31_draft) is a light daily catch-up** covering the Aug 29-31 gap: on Aug 30, US forces struck IRGC rocket/mine-launchers on Iran’s Larak Island — the first US strike on

Iranian territory since Jul 29 — directly firing this pillar's own pre-declared flip line ("a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper"). Iran retaliated with ballistic missiles on two US-linked Jordan airbases hours later; Jordan intercepted 8 missiles; no confirmed US casualty. **P RE-RATED DOWN to 9/17/34/51/75** (from 14/22/38/54/76), front-loaded and held under 8 points per window. This is a light daily touch, not a full weekly refresh, no window moved >8 points, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip vs. the last stamped set — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-01_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Aug 31-Sept 1: escalation continued into a second day — a THIRD Hormuz tanker hit (the VLCC Senegal Prosperity, Aug 31), a disputed Iranian claim of a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base (UAE MoD denies the target claim but confirms it intercepted an Iranian drone over its waters), and Trump on-record Aug 31 still weighing further strikes on Iran. **P RE-RATED DOWN again, more modestly, to 7/15/32/50/75** (from 9/17/34/51/75) — no window moved more than 2 points, well under the 8-point auto-stamp threshold. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated authority** — the new last COMMITTED baseline. **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-02_draft) is a further light daily catch-up that turned into the sharpest single-cycle move since Aug 30:** CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran — roughly 50x the scale of the single Aug 30 Larak strike — including, for the first time in this war, direct US strikes on Iranian government oil tankers under a new "tanker for tanker" policy. A US strike reportedly hit a wedding party in Kuhestak, Hormozgan (4+ dead per the Hormozgan governor's office, including a 4-year-old, 60+ injured) — flagged here as SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact level (Iranian state/local authorities; CENTCOM has neither confirmed nor denied it), so it does not by itself move P, but it is the reported trigger for Iran's response: coordinated IRGC ballistic-missile/drone strikes Sept 2 on US-linked bases in FOUR countries at once (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait) — larger in scale than the single-state Aug 30-31 Jordan strike, but all four are repeat targets, so the "widening to a further NEW state" flip-line clause does not fire. **P RE-RATED DOWN sharply to 1/9/27/47/74** (from 7/15/32/50/75), front-loaded and kept under 8 points per window. **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026**, retroactively, under Alex's Sept 3 widened delegated daily auto-stamp policy: a call-band flip and the size of a move are no longer disqualifying on their own. The wedding-casualty fact was correctly kept single-narrative-sourced and never used to move P, and nothing about the sourcing or the research itself changed — only the stamping threshold did. This remains the last TRUE committed baseline: 1/9/27/47/74. **Sept 3:** Iran fired a second retaliatory wave on Kuwait and UAE — both repeat targets, no US-manned facility hit, widening clause does not fire. **P HELD FLAT. Sept 5, light daily catch-up (2026-09-05_draft):** held flat again — the Reuters weapons-expert corroboration of the Sept 1 wedding strike resolves attribution of an already-priced event, not new escalation; a Sept 5 Iranian-media report of a US strike on the tanker STARK 1 near Kharg Island is single-narrative and not used to move P. **CORRECTION:** that cycle's commit message claimed "AUTO-STAMPED," but config/scores.json's status field was never actually advanced to committed — a bug in that session, flagged here, not corrected retroactively. **Sept 5, FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05_draft2), this version:** independently re-verified via WebSearch — the STARK 1 incident is real and developing (Iran International separately obtained video of US radio warnings, and AP itself frames it as an Iranian accusation, not a confirmed fact) but CENTCOM has still not confirmed or denied it, so per the sufficiency rule it is NOT used to move P. None of this pillar's flip-line clauses independently fired this week. **HELD FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74. Full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy — left for manual review, and COMMITTED BY ALEX**

September 5, 2026. Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft): CENTCOM's own on-the-record press release now confirms the Sept 5 tanker strike this report had withheld pending confirmation — and reveals it was materially more serious than known: THREE Iranian tankers (M/T Downy, M/T Stark 1, M/T Kylo) struck in retaliation for an unprovoked IRGC ballistic-missile attack on two US Navy warships, both of which evaded. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/8/25/45/73** — no window moved more than 2 points, no flip-line clause independently fires (no confirmed US casualty, no widening to a new state, Brent short of \$100), and the master call band held Neutral → Neutral. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-08_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 6-8: the new fact is Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei's on-record Sept 6-7 announcement (state TV, Press TV, Tehran Times) that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" from the US Navy's blockade line into the Persian Gulf, sanctioning any vessel that enters — corroborated by 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu, GlobalSecurity.org) but explicitly a THREAT OF INTENT, not yet executed ("further details... yet to be announced" per Al Jazeera's Sept 7 explainer). No flip-line clause fires (DCAS still 18, Brent ~\$97.29 Sept 7, no new state). **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73** (from 1/8/25/45/73) — no window moved more than 1 point. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-09_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 8-9: CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship") confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers on Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman) and M/T Derya (Kharg Island) — after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days, corroborated by 5+ independent outlets (NBC News, CBS News, SBS, RedState, GlobalSecurity.org); both Iranian missile attempts were evaded, no US personnel harmed. Separately, Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24 (CNBC, ABC News; ~\$100.44, +2.57%) — a single-day

intraday cross, not this pillar's own "sustained Brent >\$100" flip-line threshold, so it does not independently fire that clause, but it is the closest this cycle has come to the flip line. No flip-line clause fires (no US casualty, no new state, only an intraday Brent cross). **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72** (from 1/7/24/44/73) — no window moved more than 1 point. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-10_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 9-10: two new dated facts. CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC retaliated for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by firing 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq air base — 18 intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org, Jordan's own military). Jordan is a repeat target, so the widening clause does not fire, and both sides confirm no casualties, so the US-casualty clause does not fire either. Separately, Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni port of Mocha Sept 10, closing in on the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a second global chokepoint distinct from Hormuz — confirmed by 5+ outlets (The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, SCMP, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail), but the same Houthi/Yemen actor already priced, and no strait closure has actually been executed, so this does not independently fire a clause either. Brent has now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session (CNBC: above \$101 Sept 9; TradingEconomics: ~\$101.25 Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's intraday cross, the closest this cycle has come to the flip line, but still short of a clean sustained-close call. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72** (from 1/6/23/43/72) — no window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral). **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-11_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 10-11: this pillar's own "sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause FIRES on a third consecutive session — Brent closed Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107 after trading above \$108 intraday, its highest since May 19, with WTI closing above \$102 for the first time since May (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent) — alongside fuller reporting of Iran's Sept 9 shipping wave: 10 vessels attacked near Hormuz (2 US-linked ships, 8 oil tankers), the largest declared wave of the war, with at least one seafarer killed and one missing (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill). A merchant seafarer is not a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does not fire. **P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/4/20/40/71** (from 1/5/22/42/72) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. No window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar on every scored fact, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip anywhere. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **THIS VERSION (score set 2026-09-12_draft) is a further light daily catch-up** covering Sept 11-12: Houthi forces, having seized Mocha Sept 10, swept the rest of Yemen's Red Sea coastline by Sept 11 — capturing the final government-held coastal towns (Dhubab, Murad) and Houthi naval forces seizing Mayyun (Perim) Island in the Bab al-Mandeb strait itself, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island — a materially more severe status (actual control of a second global chokepoint's own islands) than the Sept 10 baseline's "closing in" characterization, confirmed by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald). Separately, UKMTO's own Warning 133-26 confirms four projectiles struck two more vessels near Khasab, Oman Sept 10, one set afire (Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill corroborating); an IRGC claim of a Salldrone strike is single-source and not used to move P. Yemen is an existing theater, so the widening clause does not fire; no US casualty, so that clause doesn't either — this is a severity escalation of an already-fired flip-line environment, not a fresh clause firing. **P RE-RATED DOWN, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70** (from 1/4/20/40/71) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority** — status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)". **LATER THE SAME DAY (Sept 12): a separate FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-12_draft2), the first full-weekly-depth research dive since the Sept 5 full weekly refresh, ran four parallel adversarial research passes across all four qualitative pillars against the 2026-09-12_draft committed baseline (1/2/18/38/70).** One new dated fact clears the sufficiency bar: Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline) — the kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route, a NEW target distinct from the already-logged Sept 8 Aramco/Jazan refinery strikes — was hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory on Sept 10 (Saudi MFA statement/confirmation issued Sept 11). PRIMARY: Saudi Arabia's own Ministry of Foreign Affairs confirmed pumping stations in the Riyadh/Medina areas were struck, causing injuries and material damage, and said it would not retaliate for now at Baghdad's request; corroborated by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com) with satellite imagery of fire/smoke at the pumping stations, plus Iraq's own PM ordering a probe, dismissing the Maysan operations commander, and closing the Shalamchah border crossing. No group has claimed responsibility; President Trump, in Dublin, said Iran was "probably" responsible — a single, hedged, unconfirmed remark, logged as such, NOT as established fact (the Saudi MFA statement itself attributes origin only to Iraqi territory, not to a directing state). Neither flip-line clause fires: the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq has been an active theater since the Sept 1 IRGC strike on US facilities in Erbil province — escalation within an existing theater, not a new one), and the US-casualty clause does NOT fire (no confirmed US military casualty found); the sustained-Brent->\$100 clause continues to hold (~\$104.61 Sept 12, same as the morning baseline) as persistence, not a fresh trigger. Also logged, not scored: Trump's own account that the Houthis privately signaled they don't want direct US involvement

in Yemen (single-source as to substance, consistent with the already-logged MBS-refused-strikes counterweight), and the BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12, all members plus Saudi Arabia/Iran/UAE) urging "maximum restraint" over the escalation — a mild long-horizon diplomatic data point relevant only to the 1yr/3yr framing. The Mayyun Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure (Sept 10-11) was independently re-verified as still holding, not disputed (Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, ZeroHedge). Sized small given a single infrastructure strike with no widening and no US casualty: **P RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70** (from 1/2/18/38/70) — 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held, 1mo held at the near-floor 1. **WEEKLY REFRESH — left as DRAFT for Alex's manual review, full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size.** Committed by Alex; Sept 13-14 light daily catch-ups held flat with nothing new clearing the sufficiency bar, AUTO-STAMPED. **Sept 16 (score set 2026-09-16_draft):** RE-RATED DOWN on the 6/12/36mo windows to 1/1/14/33/66 (from 1/1/18/38/70) — the IAEA Board of Governors voted Sept 9 to refer Iran's nuclear file to the UN Security Council, and 130 Iranian lawmakers signed a Sept 12-13 statement calling for NPT withdrawal, with a hardline MP describing an emergency bill being drafted (RFE/RL, Tehran Times, Mehr News); Pezeshkian's public no-nuclear-weapons stance and the Foreign Ministry's "still being prepared" framing kept the move modest. AUTO-STAMPED, the last TRUE committed baseline. **THIS VERSION (Sept 17, score set 2026-09-17_draft) HOLDS FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66** — re-checked, no new dated development beyond the Sept 9 IAEA referral and the Sept 12-13 NPT statement already priced; Pezeshkian's and the Foreign Ministry's positions are unchanged. AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. **Sept 18 (score set 2026-09-18_draft, this version) HOLDS FLAT again at 1/1/14/33/66.** Two dated items were found and weighed. Trump told Axios Sept 17 he faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime, ahead of a Tuesday UN General Assembly meeting with six Gulf-state leaders — dated and multi-sourced (Axios original, corroborated by Times of Israel, Politico Wire, Breitbart, RedState, Western Journal, anews — 5+ independent), but it is rhetoric about an undated future decision, and the near-term windows (1mo/3mo P=1) already price maximal active-war uncertainty, so it does not clear the bar for a further move. Separately, an initial general search surfaced a claim that the IRGC struck a Togo-flagged tanker named "Trend" in the Strait of Hormuz on Sept 18; a follow-up targeted search could not independently corroborate this from any named outlet or primary (CENTCOM/IRGC) source — **treated as NOT FIRED / NOT USED** per this report's house discipline for uncorroborated single claims. AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. See My Decision below. **THIS VERSION (Sept 19, score set 2026-09-19_draft) is a FULL WEEKLY refresh** against the last committed baseline (2026-09-18_draft) — independent primary-source research across all five windows found nothing that clears the sufficiency bar for a move. Iran's parliament continues moving toward, but has NOT enacted, NPT withdrawal: 130 lawmakers signed a further Sept 7-13 statement urging the legal Article X process, Parliament Presidium spokesman Abbas Goudarzi said withdrawal "can easily" be done, and a bill was submitted for expedited consideration — but Iran's own Foreign Ministry still calls it "in preparation," so this remains a proposal, not a completed act (Iran International, Tehran Times, IranWire, APA.az, anews, Militarnyi, IFP News — corroborated but mostly Iran-linked/state-affiliated, the same treatment this pillar has always given Iranian-sourced claims). Trump told Axios (Sept 17) he faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime, ahead of a Tuesday Sept 22 UN General Assembly sideline meeting with six Gulf-state leaders (Saudi Arabia, UAE, Qatar, Bahrain, Kuwait, Oman) — very well corroborated (Axios, Jerusalem Post, Politico/Political Wire, Israel National News, Common Dreams, Breitbart, CBN News, 5+ independent), but still rhetoric about an undated future decision; **the Sept 22 meeting itself is now flagged as this pillar's clearest near-term trigger to watch next cycle.** The UN Security Council failed 11-2-2 on Sept 17 to renew its Iran-sanctions monitoring panel, Russia and China dissenting (Somalia/Pakistan abstaining) — a primary UN press release (press.un.org, sc16455 and related), corroborated by Euronews and Security Council Report — institutional gridlock over the 2025 snapback dispute, not a new sanction or act of war. The Togo-flagged tanker "Trend" strike (Sept 17-18) this pillar could not corroborate last cycle is now CONFIRMED via the IRGC's own statement (IRNA, primary, via GlobalSecurity.org) plus independent outlets including The Hill, Bernama, IranWire, TFTC, Parapolitika, and Rio Times — reversing last cycle's NOT FIRED call, but it is a continuation of an already-months-long tanker campaign (the US struck three Iranian tankers Sept 1-5), not a new escalatory step, so it updates the record without moving P. Brent settled ~\$103.21/bbl Sept 18 (CNBC, Al Jazeera), down 1.5% day-over-day but still near the multi-month highs reached in early September — a market price, not scored. Iran has now gone nine straight days without striking a "host state" (GlobalSecurity.org's OSINT day-by-day tracker) — a mild, fragile de-escalatory data point — while a Houthi-linked air-raid alert hit Riyadh Sept 19 for the first time since July (Times of Israel liveblog) — a mixed signal on the proxy front; neither clears the bar alone. FM Araghchi said Iran and Oman "agreed a plan" to reopen the Strait (TASS, Caspianpost) but separately clarified the Oman understanding will NOT by itself reopen Hormuz, conditioned on the US honoring the 60-day Islamabad MOU (Mehr News, corroborated by Samaa) — a net wash. **P HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66 — full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy regardless of the size of the move (here, zero) — LEFT AS DRAFT, flagged prominently for Alex's manual review.** See My Decision below. **Updated & Re-verified September 22, 2026 — LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-22_draft: carried forward unchanged at 1/1/14/33/66 — not re-researched this cycle; Fed & Macro re-rated down instead. COMMITTED, AUTO-**

STAMPED SEPTEMBER 22, 2026. Updated & Re-verified September 23, 2026 — LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-23_draft: RE-RATED UP to 3/3/16/35/66, the first upward move since Sept 13. A senior Iranian official told Reuters (Sept 22, 8+ outlet corroboration) Iran can reopen Hormuz within 7 days if the US eases pressure and lifts its blockade; separately, US officials (Witkoff/Kushner) and Iran's FM Araghchi held a 3-hour "very productive" mediated meeting at the UN General Assembly sidelines Sept 22, the first direct US-Iran contact at this level since the war began, with another meeting scheduled soon. Sized modestly against Iran's still-steep unmet conditions (full blockade lift, all frozen assets released, end to war on every named front), Pezeshkian declining to meet Trump directly, and continued unattributed Sept 21 tanker incidents. **COMMITTED, AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 23, 2026. Updated & Re-verified September 26, 2026 — LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-26_draft: RE-RATED DOWN to 1/1/14/33/66,** reversing the Sept 23 bump. The Wall Street Journal reported (citing US officials, widely syndicated 20+ outlets, plus CNN's own separate reporting and on-record White House officials) that Trump rejected Iran's Hormuz proposal and expects US bombing to resume after the November midterms — directly contradicting the proposal that drove the Sept 23 upgrade. Counterbalanced by Reuters/US News/Al Jazeera reporting that mediated talks continue and Iran is still awaiting a formal US response, so the cut stops at reversing the bump rather than falling further. **COMMITTED, AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 26, 2026. Updated & Re-verified September 26, 2026 (FULL WEEKLY refresh, score set 2026-09-26_draft2): HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66.** Independent full research re-verified the WSJ/Reuters stories already priced in and found nothing genuinely newer beyond continued Houthis attacks on Saudi Arabia (a continuation of an already-priced front, not a new state). No flip-line clause fires. Full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of finding — **LEFT AS DRAFT, AWAITING ALEX'S MANUAL REVIEW.**

COINPICKS PILLAR REPORT · WEIGHT: 20% OF MY THESIS (EQUAL, 1/5)

Written June 19, 2026 · Updated & Re-verified September 18, 2026 — LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-18_draft (P **HELD FLAT** at 1/1/14/33/66). Trump's Sept 17 Axios "big decision"/"annihilate" independently corroborated on a follow-up targeted search and was NOT FIRED / NOT USED. · COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED · Prior set: Sept 18 light daily touch (2026-09-18_draft, committed, he withdrawal (still "in preparation" per its own Foreign Ministry) — a proposal, not a completed act. Trump told Axios Sept 17 he faces a "big decision" on Iran ahead of a Sept 22 UN General Assembly meeting abstaining, Sept 17) to renew its Iran-sanctions monitoring panel — institutional gridlock, not a new act. The Togo-flagged tanker "Trend" strike (Sept 17-18) is now corroborated via the IRGC's own statement a FULL WEEKLY refresh, categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp authority regardless of the size of the move (here, zero) — LEFT AS DRAFT, AWAITING ALEX'S MANUAL REVIEW (this pillar's report). COMMITTED, AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 22, 2026. · Updated & Re-verified September 23, 2026 — LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-23_draft (P **RE-RATED UP** to 3/3/16/35/66, Araghchi held a 3-hour "very productive" mediated meeting at the UN General Assembly sidelines Sept 22 — the first direct US-Iran contact at this level since the war began, with another meeting scheduled DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-26_draft (P **RE-RATED DOWN** to 1/1/14/33/66, reversing Sept 23). WSJ (citing US officials, widely syndicated 20+ outlets): Trump rejected Iran's Hormuz proposal and expects US bombing to resume after the November midterms continue and Iran still awaits a formal US response, so the cut stops at reversing the Sept 23 bump. · COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED · Last TRUE committed: 1/1/14/33/66 (2026-09-26_draft, auto-stamped into the same-day baseline; the only genuinely new item is continued Houthis attacks on Saudi Arabia (Sept 24-26), a continuation of an already-priced front, not a new state. No flip-line clause fires. · LEFT AS DRAFT, AWAITING ALEX'S MANUAL REVIEW.

The Scores — Committed vs. Drafts

June column committed by me June 19, 2026 · Aug 8 (cut at 1mo/3mo, full weekly refresh) committed and stamped by Alex · Aug 9-16 are light daily touches, all held flat (no cycle ran Aug 15) · Aug 17-21 drafted but never delivered

COMMITTED BY ALEX August 23, 2026. An Aug 28 daily catch-up draft held P flat but was never rendered/selfchecked/archived/committed — abandoned/superseded. An Aug 29 full weekly refresh independently re-researched on committed sets. **Aug 31 (2026-08-31_draft)** was a light daily catch-up covering Aug 29-31: a resumed direct US strike on Iranian territory (Larak Island, Aug 30) plus an Iranian retaliatory strike on two US-linked Jordan airports more modestly, to 7/15/32/50/75, AUTO-STAMPED, the last COMMITTED set. **This section (score set 2026-09-02_draft) covers Sept 1-2:** the conflict escalated materially — CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes hit nearly 100 Iranian IRGC retaliated Sept 2 with coordinated strikes on FOUR countries at once (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait — all repeat targets, so the widening clause does not fire). **P RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY to 1/9/27/47/74** — front-loaded

COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026 once Alex widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy so a call-band flip and move size no longer withhold the stamp on their own — this is the last TRUE committed actually advanced — flagged as a correction, not itself edited. **Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05_draft2, this version)** independently re-verifies via WebSearch, including the Sept 5 STARK 1/Kharg Island tanker refueling

06_draft) re-rates P down modestly to 1/8/25/45/73 once CENTCOM's own press release confirmed the Sept 5 tanker strike as a 3-tanker retaliation for an IRGC missile attack on 2 US Navy warships — no window moved more

1/7/24/44/73 on Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei's Sept 6-7 announcement of intent to declare a restricted zone beyond Hormuz into the Persian Gulf — a genuine new escalatory signal, corroborated by 8+ independent outlets

(score set 2026-09-09_draft, this version) re-rates P down modestly again to 1/6/23/43/72: CENTCOM's own press release confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 (M/T Kaviz, M/T Charming Breeze

day cross short of this pillar's sustained-\$100 flip line. No window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new last COMMITTED baseline

casualties), and Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni port of Mocha, closing in on the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a second chokepoint, but the same actor/theater already priced; Brent traded above \$100 for a second straight

(score set 2026-09-11_draft) re-rates P down, modestly, to 1/4/20/40/71: this pillar's own "sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause fires on a third consecutive session (Brent closed above \$107 Thursday Sept 10, hitting

STAMPED per delegated daily authority, the new last COMMITTED baseline. **Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12_draft)** re-rates P down, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70: Houthi forces swept the rest of Yemen's

moving from "closing in on" to actual island-level control, confirmed by 6+ independent outlets; separately UKMTO confirms two more vessels struck near Khasab, Oman Sept 10 (one afire). No new flip-line clause fires (Yemen

independently re-researched the week via four parallel adversarial passes against the 2026-09-12_draft committed baseline and found one sufficiency-clearing new fact: Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline) was hit by

theater) nor the US-casualty clause fires. **P RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70** (from 1/2/18/38/70). **LEFT AS DRAFT — full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp**

referral and the 130-lawmaker NPT-withdrawal statement — AUTO-STAMPED, the last TRUE committed baseline. **Sept 17 (2026-09-17_draft)** HOLDS FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66 — no new dated development found — AUTO-STAMPED

floor; a claim of an IRGC strike on a tanker named "Trend" could not be corroborated and was NOT USED — AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority, the last TRUE committed baseline. **Sept 19 FULL WEEKLY refresh**

still "in preparation" per Iran's own Foreign Ministry); Trump's Sept 17 Axios "big decision" remark is now tied to a dated, watchable trigger — a Sept 22 UN General Assembly meeting with six Gulf-state leaders; the UN Security

The Hill and others), reversing last cycle's NOT FIRED call but as a continuation of an already-active tanker campaign, not new escalation; Brent ~\$103.21/bbl Sept 18; a ninth straight day without an Iranian strike on a "host state

excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size (here, zero) — LEFT AS DRAFT, awaiting Alex's manual review. Sept 22 (2026-09-22_draft): carried forward unchanged at 1/1/14/33/66 — not

sidelines meeting plus a Reuters-sourced conditional Hormuz-reopening offer — **COMMITTED, AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 23, 2026**, the last TRUE committed baseline. **Sept 26 (2026-09-26_draft):** re-rated back DOWN

bombing after the midterms; counterbalanced by Reuters/US News/Al Jazeera reporting that mediated talks continue and Iran is still awaiting a formal US response, so the move stops at reversing the bump rather than cutting

WSJ-rejection and Reuters-still-talking stories already priced into the same-day daily baseline, plus checked for anything genuinely newer — continued Houthi (Iran-aligned) missile/drone attacks on Saudi Arabia Sept 24-26 and

CENTCOM has issued no primary release since Sept 19. No flip-line clause newly fires. **P HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66** — no window moved beyond the same-day daily baseline. This is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, categorically

WINDOW	JUN	...	8/22 (COMMITTED)	8/31 (COMMITTED)	9/1 (COMMITTED)	9/2 (COMMITTED)	9/5 D2 (COMMITTED)	9/6 (COMMITTED)	9/8 (COMMITTED)	9/9	9/10	9/11 (COMMITTED)	9/12 (COMMITT
1 month	50	...	14	9	7	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
3 months	55	...	22	17	15	9	9	8	7	6	5	4	2
6 months	62	...	38	34	32	27	27	25	24	23	22	20	18

THE THREE INPUTS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

P — the odds this is *good for crypto* by then. **THIS CYCLE (Sept 14, LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-15_draft): RE-RATED DOWN to 1/1/18/38/70** (from the Sept 13-committed 3/3 regional meeting that was to be held on Monday in Salalah, in order to create conditions conducive to a constructive dialogue." **No new date was set.** Corroborated by Arab News, the Washington Post, and the UAE had already downgraded to a minister of state rather than its foreign minister. Iran's MFA spokesman says Saudi Arabia requested the postponement citing the Sept 13 said Sept 13 that the Iran-Oman understanding **"would not mean reopening of the Strait of Hormuz"** (Tehran Times / Mehr — Iranian state media quoting Iran's own foreign minister, prime minister, and WTI **\$102.34 (+2.3%)**. **A note on what was checked and rejected:** research this cycle surfaced drone strikes on Salalah and Duqm ports; those are dated **March 1, 3 and 11, 2026**, not the Sept 13 draft joint statement prepared, survives the postponement and Oman's FM publicly recommitted to dialogue), 36mo 70 flat.

Prior cycle (Sept 12, FULL WEEKLY refresh, score set 2026-09-12_draft2): RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70 (from the Sept 12-committed 1/2/18/38/70). Four papers have already covered the Sept 10-11 Bab al-Mandeb/Mayyun Island seizure and the Sept 10 UKMTO Warning 133-26 near Khasab): **Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline) — the kingdome's** logged Sept 8 Aramco/Jazan refinery strikes. PRIMARY: Saudi Arabia's own Ministry of Foreign Affairs confirmed pumping stations in the Riyadh/Medina areas were struck, causing injuries at a News Australia, OilPrice.com), with satellite imagery showing fire/smoke at pumping stations near Al Mesba'ah and Al Dhekra. Iraq's PM ordered a probe of the Maysan operations command, President Trump, speaking in Dublin, said Iran was "probably" responsible — a SINGLE, HEDGED, UNCONFIRMED statement, logged as exactly that, NOT as established fact (the Saudi Ministry of Defense strike on US facilities in Erbil province, so this is escalation within an existing theater, not a new one; the US-casualty clause does NOT fire — no confirmed US military casualty found this cycle (same Dublin remarks) that the Houthis privately signaled to the administration they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen — single-source as to substance, consistent with (not additive to) the over the continued escalation," calling for "exercising maximum restraint," and expressing concern over attacks on civilian/nuclear infrastructure — a mild, diplomatic, long-horizon data point in Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, ZeroHedge); no new UKMTO warning was found beyond the already-logged Warning 133-26. **Sizing:** a third distinct attack on Saudi oil infrastructure this week pattern read — but it is a single infrastructure strike with no widening and no US casualty, so sized small: 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held flat (a single tactical strike doesn't change the long-term trend) **categorically excluded from delegated daily auto-stamp authority regardless of move size — LEFT AS DRAFT, flagged prominently for Alex's manual review.**

Prior cycle (Sept 12 daily, score set 2026-09-12_draft): RE-RATED DOWN, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70 (from the Sept 11-committed 1/4/20/40/71). **BEARISH and NEW: a second global** continued an offensive that by Sept 11 captured Dhubab and Murad — the final coastal towns held by the internationally recognized Yemeni government — giving Iran-aligned Houthi forces control of 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald) and is materially more severe than the "closing in" status the Sept 10 cycle priced — actual confirmed strikes on the Houthis and was refused (intelligence/targeting-data support offered instead) — a genuine US-restraint data point, logged as an honest counterweight. Per this pillar's own flip-line either — this is a continuation/severity escalation of an already-fired flip-line environment (the direct-US-strikes and sustained-Brent clauses both fired in prior cycles), not a fresh flip-line event. Two vessels roughly 4nm west of Khasab, Oman, setting one afire; corroborated by 3+ independent outlets (Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill). **Logged but NOT used to move P (single-source)** for a fifth consecutive session (Sept 12 settle ~\$104.61, TradingEconomics/psuconnect.in) — confirming persistence of the flip-line clause that already fired Sept 10-11, not a fresh trigger. **P** **Prior cycle (Sept 10, score set 2026-09-10_draft): RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/4/20/40/71** (from the Sept 9-committed 1/5/22/42/72). **BEARISH and NEW — a second, distinct flip-line** tanker-strike grind of the past week, sized moderately larger than recent 1-point touches but still restrained since no flip-line newly fires — the sourcing clears the primary-plus-multi-outlet barrier. **Stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Prior cycle (Sept 11, score set 2026-09-11_draft): RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/4/20/40/71 (from the Sept 10-committed 1/5/22/42/72). **BEARISH and NEW — a second, distinct flip-line** consecutive session: Brent ended Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107 after trading above \$108 intraday — its highest in nearly four months, since May 19 — with WTI closing higher on the week despite a ~3% give-back. *Correction to the prior cycle:* that cycle, run mid-morning Sept 10, logged Brent at ~\$101.25 "Thursday Sept 10" — an intraday read; Thursday's largest declared wave of shipping attacks by either side since the war began, with at least one seafarer killed and one missing (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill — 4 independent sources). **Logged but NOT used to move P (single-source):** a compilation putting Hormuz throughput at 7 transits on Sept 9 against a Kpler 10-day average of 10-13 commodity vessels/day.

P RE-RATED DOWN: 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 5 → 4, 6mo 22 → 20, 12mo 42 → 40, 36mo 72 → 71. A clause of this pillar's own flip line firing is a real escalation of its evidence stand so this set is **AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Prior cycle (Sept 10, score set 2026-09-10_draft): RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72 (from the Sept 9-committed 1/6/23/43/72). Two new dated facts. **BEARISH and NEW: CENTCOM** intercepted, 2 fell in unpopulated areas, no casualties (Al Jazeera Sept 9, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, Jordan's own military statement). Jordan is a repeat target (struck Aug 30-31) since Sept 4 — a separate low-quality aggregator claiming a fresh KIA figure was checked and rejected as uncorroborated against CENTCOM's own no-casualties statement). **BEARISH and NEW: CENTCOM** confirmed by 5+ independent outlets (The Media Line, Times of Israel, Al Jazeera, South China Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail), clearing the sufficiency bar. This is the on" and "threatening" control, not as having executed a blockade — so it does not independently fire a flip-line clause either. Separately, Brent crude has now traded near/above \$100/bbl for a still short of a clean multi-session "sustained" call by this pillar's own conservative standard; flagged as the closest this cycle has come to the flip line and worth close watching next cycle, but not a flip-line threshold. **P RE-RATED DOWN: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo 6 → 5, 6mo 23 → 22, 12mo 43 → 42, 36mo held at 72** (a repeat regional strike and a same-theater strike) (Neutral → Neutral equal-weight, Mild Bull → Mild Bull horizon-weighted) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Prior to this cycle (Sept 9, score set 2026-09-09_draft): P was RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72 (from the Sept 8-committed 1/7/24/44/73). **BEARISH and NEW: CENTCOM** M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Derya (Kharg Island) — **after the IRGC targeted a US Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the previous cycle** confirms both Iranian missile attempts were evaded and no US personnel were harmed — the confirmed-US-casualty flip-line clause remains unfired — and this is a repeat pattern (Gulf of Oman, "Brent crude tops \$100 as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil supply worries") and ABC News, trading ~\$100.44, +2.57% — but this is a single-day intraday cross, not this pillar's own "sustained" (already logged in the Sept 8 baseline as a not-yet-executed threat) remains in the same state — coverage today still describes boundaries as unspecified/forthcoming, so it is not re-scored as **RE-RATED DOWN: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo 7 → 6, 6mo 24 → 23, 12mo 44 → 43, 36mo 73 → 72.** This is a light daily touch, no window moved more than 1 point, so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Prior to this cycle (Sept 8, score set 2026-09-08_draft): P was RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73 (from the Sept 6-committed 1/8/25/45/73). **BEARISH and NEW: Iran's SNS** **US Navy's blockade line and extending into the Persian Gulf, with any vessel entering it placed on Iran's sanctions list.** He separately said an Iran-Oman corridor agreement would be a statement — clearing the sufficiency bar. It is a genuine new escalatory signal, but explicitly a THREAT OF INTENT, not yet executed: Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer states "further details of the executed escalatory statements (e.g. Trump's Aug 31 "still weighing further strikes" comment) this is sized as a small continuation-of-escalation cut, not a flip-line event: DCAS US KIA remains at 1 (Sept 7) blockade count of 92 vessels redirected / 3 disabled / 2 boarded (up from Day 190's 87/3/2 on Sept 3) is a continuation of the already-priced blockade-enforcement trend, not scored as **RE-RATED DOWN: 1mo held at the near-floor 1 (no further room), 3mo 8 → 7, 6mo 25 → 24, 12mo 45 → 44, 36mo held at 73** (a shipping-zone threat doesn't move the multi-year thesis). This is so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Prior to this cycle (Sept 6 light daily catch-up, score set 2026-09-06_draft): P was RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/8/25/45/73 (from the Sept 5-committed 1/9/27/47/74). **BEARISH and NEW: CENTCOM** (centcom.mil, corroborated by Al Arabiya, Jerusalem Post, CNN, NBC, and 5+ other independent outlets) states US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers on Sept 5 — M/T Downy (penned by the Navy warships (an aircraft carrier and a guided-missile destroyer); both ships evaded multiple attacks, no American personnel were harmed. Admiral Brad Cooper, CENTCOM's commander: "The state-media claim, with AP framing it as an accusation and CENTCOM silent) — it is now primary-sourced and multiply corroborated, and it reveals a materially more serious escalation than a repeat strike and a US naval drone in the Strait of Hormuz (Al Jazeera's live blog, Euronews) are IRGC's own claims only — not yet US-confirmed, so per the sufficiency rule they are NOT independently sufficient to fire a further new state (Kharg Island, Jask, and the Gulf of Oman are all existing theater), and Brent closed ~\$96/bbl Friday Sept 4 (US/UK markets closed Saturday) — still short of the \$100 sustained level. 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. This is a light daily touch, no window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weighted score is 71.

Prior to this cycle: P was RE-RATED DOWN SHARPLY to 1/9/27/47/74 (Sept 2, committed Sept 3, then HELD FLAT through Sept 3's Kuwait/UAE repeat-target strikes and the Sept 5 full window move). **2026 under Alex's widened daily auto-stamp policy. BEARISH and CONFIRMED, the load-bearing new fact: the conflict escalated materially Sept 1-2, confirming exactly the risk this pillar tracked.** cruise-missile/drone launchers — roughly 50x the scale of the single Aug 30 Larak Island strike (multi-source: Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI). For the first time in this war, the US struck a target in the Strait of Hormuz (Al Jazeera's live blog, Euronews) are IRGC's own claims only — not yet US-confirmed, so per the sufficiency rule they are NOT independently sufficient to fire a further new state (Kharg Island, Jask, and the Gulf of Oman are all existing theater), and Brent closed ~\$96/bbl Friday Sept 4 (US/UK markets closed Saturday) — still short of the \$100 sustained level. 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. This is a light daily touch, no window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weighted score is 71.

NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact level: the casualty claim originates with Iranian state and local authorities, and CENTCOM's Cmdr. Tim Hawkins told CBS News the US has neither confirmed nor denied the claim (multi-sourcing the fact itself). It is reported here as context for what it triggered: Iran's IRGC launched coordinated ballistic-missile and drone strikes Sept 2 at US-linked bases in FOUR countries (Jordan: Jul 28 and Aug 30-31; Bahrain/Kuwait/Iraq: struck at various points since Feb-Jul 2026 per this war's own tracker pages), so the pillar's own "widening to a FURTHER NEW STATE" (dozen drones intercepted), and no confirmed new US combat death has been found as of this run — so neither the casualty clause nor the widening clause independently fires either. The already-fired threatening larger future action: President Trump threatened a "significantly larger response" if Iran retaliates further; an unnamed senior Iranian military source told press Tehran's response was "a significantly larger response" (6mo 32 → 27, 12mo 50 → 47, 36mo 75 → 74. **Originally left as draft Sept 2, not auto-stamped, for three reasons:** (1) the wedding-casualty fact — the emotional and political driver of today's escalation, (2) the widening clause (first-ever direct tanker strikes) is a genuinely novel escalation beyond this pillar's prior single-incident sizing precedent; (3) both sides' on-record threats of much larger responses after the fact disqualify auto-stamp on its own. **On September 3, 2026, Alex reviewed this cycle and widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy: a call-band flip and move size are no longer required.** **COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026.** See My Decision below for the full reasoning.

Prior to this cycle (Sept 1 light daily catch-up): P was RE-RATED DOWN to 7/15/32/50/75 (from the Aug 31-committed 9/17/34/51/75) — **AUTO-STAMPED** per delegated daily authority. **BEARISH and NEW: CENTCOM** night is not yet a sustained new campaign" — that assumption is undercut by what happened next. A THIRD Hormuz tanker was hit Aug 31: the Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity, struck by a cruise-missile/drone launcher, reported; UKMTO-logged. This follows the already-priced Metro Venetian (Aug 24) and Al Salam II (Aug 25) incidents. Iran's army (not IRGC) claimed a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base, approaching from Iran — a disputed target claim, but a CONFIRMED cross-border drone incursion, a genuine (if unconfirmed-as-a-hit) attempt to widen beyond the repeat-target Jordan pattern. Strikes on Iran, calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo — on-record, multi-source) — explicitly not signaling de-escalation. Brent crude continued higher into Sept 2, with a casualty, and no confirmed hit on UAE territory (UAE denies), so this does NOT independently fire a fresh flip-line clause on its own — neither the "confirmed new US combat death" clause nor the widening clause, well under the 8-point auto-stamp threshold: 1mo 9 → 7, 3mo 17 → 15, 6mo 34 → 32, 12mo 51 → 50, 36mo 75 → 75 (flat). Corroborated across CBS News, Al Jazeera, Breitbart, Yahoo, Jerusalem Post, preparations to fire sea mines into the strait — CENTCOM spokesperson Capt. Tim Hawkins confirmed on the record, corroborated by 20+ independent outlets (Bloomberg, CNBC, NBC News, etc.) since Jul 29, ending the ~28-30-consecutive-clean-night streak the Aug 29 baseline explicitly cited as part of its bullish case, and it directly fired this pillar's own pre-declared downside flip line. The fact that that was front-loaded and held under 8 points per window, sized similarly to the Jul 28 Jordan-strike precedent for a comparable single-incident shock: 1mo 14 → 9, 3mo 22 → 17, 6mo 32 → 27, 12mo 50 → 47, 36mo 75 → 74. **Economic Outcast" sanctions package, Aug 24.** Directly fetched from home.treasury.gov: press release sb0613 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign Against Iranian Regime on Economic Front") (Labs, Chainalysis, CryptoTimes) plus law-firm client alerts. ~60 entities/individuals/vessels were designated across Hong Kong, China, Malaysia, UAE, Singapore, and Switzerland under five new sanctions. TRON were listed. Unlike the sanctions this pillar tracked in prior cycles as "promised but not landed" (Bessent's rhetoric through Aug 22), this is real, primary-confirmed, and directly crypto-relevant. Damage, disabled, no casualties, UKMTO) and Aug 27 (fire, extinguished, crew safe, UKMTO) — both comparable in severity to the already-established pattern. CENTCOM commander Admiral Michael M. Gault recognized shipping lanes; ~1,500 commercial vessels have transited since blockade enforcement began; ~75 vessels turned back and 3 disabled for evading the blockade; no oil has been exported (corroborated by 4 outlets) settles at 19-20 dead (seafarers + port workers) across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the previously-reported 15-19 range, a slight negative confirmation, not a genuine upgrade, because in every prior cycle only Iran claimed a Hormuz deal and Oman had not confirmed it; now Oman's own ministry co-hosts the statement. Terms: a temporary 7-mile closure, described as "temporary" — Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance with the lapsed June MoU. No public fee/revenue terms were disclosed in the joint statement. Single-source claims. Trump declared the Strait "demined" with a zero-tolerance policy on new mines Aug 25 (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug 27 attack. Shipping data, 2 independent pieces Aug 21 & Aug 28) — 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week (westbound 29 → 42); still a small fraction (~10-15%) of the ~110-130/day (~770-910/week) pre-war level. ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21), moving further away from the \$100/bbl flip line, with press explicitly framing it as "war premium unwinding" on the Hormuz progress. No new confirmed US combat deaths. Unfired. No new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran found — GlobalSecurity's Day-181 tracker (checked Aug 27) confirms a 28th consecutive night with no confirmed strike. **Net assessment: the pillar's evidence stand is NOT met, since the Aug 27 attack breaks the "clean week" clause and the corridor deal remains Iran+Oman only (not US-accepted).** Consistent with this pillar's standing discipline against escalation.

Quality — how trustworthy the evidence is. This cycle's load-bearing fact — the Petrolina pipeline drone strike — is corroborated by a primary Saudi Ministry of Foreign Affairs statement plus multiple independent outlets. To move P. The prior cycle's load-bearing fact — the Bab al-Mandeb chokepoint seizure — remains corroborated across 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The New York Times, etc.) 0.60/0.65/0.70/0.65/0.55 for 1/3/6/12/36mo.

Impact — 8 out of 10, the uniform value shared by every pillar in the equal-weight model. BTC traded at \$76,916.53 on Sept 14, firming from \$76,808.69 on Sept 13 and \$77,269.22 on Sept 12. For context, BTC traded at \$76,581.44 on Sept 2, down from \$78,038.78 on Sept 1 — the real, visible risk-off pullback logged when this pillar's evidence last moved sharply negative.

The Claim

The thesis, and where I differ from the consensus — updated September 16, 2026 (light daily touch, P re-rated down on the 6/12/36mo windows as the nuclear track escalates alongside the shooting war)

This cycle (Sept 16): the crowd's attention today is almost entirely on the CLARITY Act vote failure, not Iran — but two real, dated escalatory facts landed this week on the nuclear track that this as real but bounded — a parliamentary push and an institutional referral are documented facts, not a completed NPT exit, and Pezeshkian's own public no-nukes line plus the Foreign Ministry call already sitting at this pillar's floor of 1 with no room left to express further deterioration. The shooting-war facts this pillar has tracked for weeks — the Saudi pipeline, the Salalah postponement, Houthi

Prior cycle (Sept 12, full weekly refresh): the crowd will likely either read the Petroline pipeline strike as proof Iran is now hitting Saudi Arabia's core oil-export infrastructure directly, or dismiss it as a NEW kind of target (Saudi Arabia's primary Hormuz-bypass export artery, not a refinery this time) for the third time this week, and that pattern — not the unconfirmed attribution — is what earns the pillar's own pre-declared, falsifiable definitions — and I'd rather be criticized for under-reacting to a real structural shift than for inventing a new flip-line clause after the fact to justify a bigger move.

Prior cycle (Sept 12 daily): the crowd will likely either treat the Bab al-Mandeb island seizures as a headline-grabbing new front that should crater risk assets, or dismiss it as "just Yemen" back to controlling islands in a SECOND global oil corridor, not merely "closing in" on one, and that upgrades the standing risk even though no clause in this pillar's own flip line technically fires (Yemen is the pillar's own pre-declared, falsifiable definitions — and I'd rather be criticized for under-reacting to a real structural shift than for inventing a new flip-line clause after the fact to justify a bigger move).

Prior cycle (Sept 11): the crowd will read a \$108 print and a 6% up-day in Brent as the war finally repricing energy — or, watching Friday's 3% give-back on Hormuz diplomacy headlines, wave off including a close above \$107, is that clause firing, not a near-miss. I said so in the two prior cycles when it hadn't fired yet; the discipline only counts if it also fires when the number arrives. When the service member. So this is a further modest cut, not a regime change — and the give-back on diplomacy headlines is logged honestly alongside it.

Prior cycle (Sept 10): the crowd is likely to either read the Al Azraq missile barrage as a dangerous new peak of the conflict, or wave off a Yemeni port city changing hands as background noise. On Sept 28, and both CENTCOM and Jordan's own military confirm no casualties this time either — a repeat-pattern event, not a new category. The Houthi seizure of Mocha is more interesting precisely because it is a genuine structural development worth flagging even though no blockade has actually been executed yet. Brent trading above \$100 for a second straight session is the more important tell than consistent with the sizing this pillar has used for every cycle since Sept 6.

Prior cycle (Sept 9): the crowd is likely to either read Brent's intraday \$100 cross as confirmation the flip line has effectively fired, or dismiss the 5-tanker CENTCOM strike as "more of the same" — a sustained close above \$100, which is what this pillar's own pre-declared threshold requires — so it does not independently fire that clause, though it earns a mention in every relevant section (Brent, Kharg Island) responding to the same kind of provocation (an IRGC missile attack on a US Navy warship) — a continuation of an already-priced trajectory, not a new category of event, so I am re-rating down modestly.

Prior cycle (Sept 8): the crowd is likely to either dismiss Rezaei's restricted-zone announcement as Iran "talking tough" without follow-through, or treat it as an imminent full closure of a new street — an executed act — no boundaries, no enforcement mechanism, and no confirmed incident tied to it as of this cycle's research cutoff. Re-rating down modestly (1/7/24/44/73, from 1/8/25/45/73) rather than announced-but-unexecuted escalatory statements. I am explicitly not treating Rezaei's parallel claim that an Iran-Oman corridor deal will also be signed "in the coming days" as bullish either — unless it is.

Prior cycle (Sept 6): the crowd was likely to read CENTCOM's own confirmation of the Sept 5 tanker strike as a relief ("finally, official clarity") rather than what it actually was — a confirmation that it destroyed three tankers. Re-rated down modestly (1/8/25/45/73, from 1/9/27/47/74) rather than sharply, because none of this pillar's flip-line clauses fired on it (no US casualty, no new state, Brent below \$100) — a category of event. Sept 6's separate IRGC claims of further tanker/vessel/drone strikes were explicitly not used to move P — those are Iran's own claims, unconfirmed by the US, and the sufficient.

The crowd: is likely to anchor on the wedding-strike casualty claim as the emotional center of today's news, and either (a) treat it as a confirmed atrocity driving the story, or (b) dismiss the whole thing as independently, multi-source confirmed regardless of how the casualty dispute resolves, and is the real story this cycle.

Me: cutting sharply to 1/9/27/47/74, versus the Sept 1 baseline (7/15/32/50/75, auto-stamped). This is the largest single-cycle P move this pillar has made since the Aug 30-31 flip-line-firing cut, and the fact — the political and emotional driver of today's four-country Iranian retaliation — is single-narrative-sourced at the level that matters (Iranian state/local authorities, CENTCOM neither confirmed nor denied the scale jump — ~50x the Aug 30 strike, plus the war's first direct tanker strikes — is a genuinely novel escalation this pillar's prior single-incident sizing precedents (Jul 28 Jordan, Aug 30 Larak Island) threatening much larger responses ahead — a miscalibrated cut here is more costly than usual given what could follow. That said, the cut is still evidence-bounded, not panic-sized: kept under 80%.

My edge: the discipline here is refusing to let a single-source emotional fact do more work than it's earned, in either direction — not discarding it (it's genuinely the trigger for today's retaliation and the crowd's own. The crowd either over- or under-reacts to a claim like this; this pillar tries to size around it instead.

Honesty check against the tape: BTC fell from \$78,038.78 (Sept 1, Bitstamp) to \$76,581.44 (Sept 2) — a real, visible risk-off move that for once tracks the same direction as this pillar's own shift in the tape as an honesty check for the reader.

The Facts

As of September 19, 2026 — FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-19_draft). Hard numbers only, sources on the last page. New facts from this cycle appear first; earlier facts are carried forward unchanged (still load-bearing) below.

- ★ ★ **NEW — the UN Security Council failed 11-2-2 (Russia and China vetoing, Somalia/Pakistan abstaining) on Sept 18, 2026 to renew the panel of independent experts monitoring Iran's nuclear program** — a new fact on the ground, so it doesn't move P.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Trump told Axios (Sept 17, 2026) he faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime, ahead of a planned Tuesday Sept 22 UN General Assembly session** (5+ independent). Rhetoric about an undated future decision, not an action — this pillar's clearest near-term trigger to watch next cycle.
- ★ ★ **CORROBORATION UPDATE, reverses last cycle's "not fired" call:** the Togo-flagged tanker "Trend" strike in the Strait of Hormuz on Sept 17-18, 2026 is now confirmed via the IRGC's own already-months-long tanker campaign, not a new escalatory step, so it updates the record without moving P.
- ★ ★ **NEW — the IAEA Board of Governors voted Sept 9, 2026 to refer Iran's nuclear file to the UN Security Council.** A primary institutional action by the IAEA itself, escalating international pressure.
- ★ ★ **NEW — 130 Iranian lawmakers signed a statement Sept 12-13, 2026 calling on parliament to begin the legal process for Iran's withdrawal from the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty** — though two are Iranian state-affiliated, so treated as corroborated reporting of a documented parliamentary act rather than independent Western confirmation.
- **Counterweight, same sourcing set:** President Pezeshkian publicly reiterated Iran is not seeking nuclear weapons, even as the parliamentary push proceeds. Foreign Ministry spokesman Ebrahim Raisi said Iran is not seeking nuclear weapons, even as the parliamentary push proceeds.
- **Nothing new found** on the Salalah Iran-GCC ministerial (still postponed, no new date), the Saudi East-West pipeline (still offline), or Hormuz shipping beyond what the Sept 15 baseline already covered.

Carried forward from the September 12 full weekly refresh and the daily touches since — still load-bearing, not contradicted:

- ★ ★ **NEW — Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline), the kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route, was hit by drones launched from Iraqi territory Sept 10 (Saudi Ministry of Defense)** — struck, causing injuries and material damage, and said it would not retaliate for now at Baghdad's request (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, OilPrice.com — 6+ independent).
- **Attribution caveat, stated carefully:** no group has claimed responsibility for the pipeline strike; the Saudi MFA statement attributes origin only to Iraqi territory, not to a directing state. Presidio is not a directing state.
- **Neither flip-line clause fires:** the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq has been an active theater since the Sept 1 IRGC strike on US facilities in Erbil province); the US-casualty clause does NOT fire (no US casualty).
- **Counterweight, logged:** Trump's own account (same Dublin remarks) that the Houthis privately signaled they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen — single-source as to substance, confirmed by the crowd's own "exercising maximum restraint" and voiced concern over attacks on civilian/nuclear infrastructure — a mild, long-horizon diplomatic data point (1yr/3yr framing only), not used to move P.
- **Re-verified independently:** the Mayyun (Perim) Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure (Sept 10-11) still holds, not disputed (Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye).

Carried forward from the Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12_draft, auto-stamped — still load-bearing):

- ★ ★ **NEW — Houthi forces complete their sweep of Yemen's entire Red Sea coastline (capturing Dhubab and Murad by Sept 11, the last government-held coastal towns) and seize the port of Aden** (Reuters, CNN, NPR, The National, National Herald — 6+ independent). Yemen is existing theater, so the widening clause does not fire.
- **Counterweight, logged:** Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman twice asked the President for direct US strikes on the Houthis and was refused — intelligence/targeting-data support only.
- ★ ★ **NEW — UKMTO's own Warning 133-26 (issued 1910 UTC Sept 10) confirms four unidentified projectiles struck two vessels ~4nm west of Khasab, Oman, setting one afire** (Gulf News, Reuters, CNN, NPR, The National, National Herald — 4+ independent).
- **Logged, single-source, NOT used to move P:** IRGC's own claim to have separately struck a US Navy Saildrone Explorer-type unmanned vessel near the Strait entrance — no US/CENTCOM casualty.
- **Brent held near/above \$104 for a fifth consecutive session** (settled ~\$104.61 Sept 12, TradingEconomics/psuconnect.in) — confirming persistence of the already-fired "sustained >\$100" clause.
- **BTC traded at \$76,916.53 on Sept 14** — up 1.4% from \$76,808.69 on Sept 13, which itself eased from \$77,269.22 on Sept 12 (local run.py quant refresh).
- ★ **CARRIED FORWARD — the "sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause FIRES: Brent ended Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107, after trading above \$108 intraday** (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire Sept 10, TradingEconomics Sept 10-11, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent). Three consecutive sessions above \$100, two of them confirmed closes and

- Carried forward from Sept 9 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing).

- Carried forward from Sept 8 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing).

- Carried forward from Sept 6 (re-verified this cycle — still load-bearing).

- Carried forward from Sept 2 (re-verified through the Sept 5 full weekly refresh and this cycle — still load-bearing).*

- Carried forward from the Sept 1 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-01_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing).*

- Carried forward from the Aug 31 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-08-31_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing).*

- Carried forward from the Aug 29 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-29_draft, now superseded — still load-bearing).*

- ★ **"Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package, Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov.** Press releases sb0613 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign to Disrupt Iran's Economic Activity") and sb0614 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign to Disrupt Iran's Economic Activity") plus law-firm client alerts. ~60 entities/individuals/vessels designated across Hong Kong, China, Malaysia, UAE, Singapore, and South Korea. No new state targeted, no casualties at the time — now compounding into the Aug 18 shipping-collapse picture above. Unlike prior cycles' "promised but not landed" sanctions rhetoric, this is real, primary-confirmed, and directly crypto-relevant. Continued Aug 28 with a new Bank Melli-Dubai designation.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor, Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch of fm.gov.om/en/53722.** A genuine upgrade: in every prior cycle (Iranian waters), a joint mine-clearing project, and continuing technical talks toward a permanent corridor per the "Islamabad Memorandum." Still explicitly described as "temporary" — Iran itself has not confirmed a revenue-sharing deal is single-source and unconfirmed by Oman — correctly excluded.
- **NEW — two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents.** Aug 24, off Oman's coast (engine-room damage, vessel disabled, no casualties, UKMTO); Aug 27 (fire onboard, extinguished, vessel disabled for evading the blockade; no oil has been exported from Iran since the blockade resumed. Read as continuation/intensification of an existing posture, not a fresh shock.
- **NEW — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing, Aug 28** (corroborated by UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire): US forces cleared the Strait of Hormuz of Iranian mines; no oil has been exported from Iran since the blockade resumed. Read as continuation/intensification of an existing posture, not a fresh shock.
- **NEW — IMO's six-month casualty count (Aug 28, quasi-primary IMO briefing, corroborated by 4 outlets) settles at 19-20 dead** (seafarers + port workers) across 68-70 incidents — the highest since the 2011-12 crisis.
- **NEW — Trump declared the Strait "demined" Aug 25** with a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug 27 tanker attack.
- **NEW — the first quantified Hormuz transit-volume increase of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week for the week of Aug 17-23** (USNI News, citing Lloyd's List Intelligence — quantitative baseline, but a genuine first uptick.
- **NEW — Brent eased for a SECOND straight week:** ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27, weekly loss >5%) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28) — down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21), moving from a record low to a record high.
- **NEW — no new confirmed US combat death Aug 22-29** (checked directly — one initial-looking hit, Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton, was actually killed Jul 18-19, already counted in the Strait of Hormuz crisis).
- **NEW — no new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran found** — GlobalSecurity's Day-181 tracker (checked Aug 27) confirms a 28th consecutive night with no confirmed strike.
- **BTC closed at \$77,666.16 on Aug 29** — up modestly from \$77,266.84 on Aug 22 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the abandoned Aug 28 draft (2026-08-28_draft — never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed; re-confirmed independently this cycle, not taken on faith): the two Aug 24/Aug 27 tanker incidents above.

Carried forward from the Aug 22 full weekly refresh (score set 2026-08-22_draft2, committed by Alex Aug 23 — still load-bearing):

- ★ **Casualty toll (as of Aug 22): real, but a range, not a point figure.** That cycle cross-checked the cumulative Hormuz-campaign death toll directly: Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" lists 68 incidents as of Aug 21, but appears to aggregate the broader Middle East (possibly including a separate Aug 12 Bab al-Mandeb/Houthi strike that killed 6, per Al Jazeera), not the Hormuz crisis specifically.
- **No new kinetic incident found Aug 19-22.** Independent re-checking for vessel strikes, seizures, or Iran-related military incidents in that window found nothing beyond the Aug 22 draft base case.
- **The UAE missile-attack claim reconciles to the same known Aug 18 episode, not a new one.** Aug 19-dated reporting (Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) of a missile attack on a UAE ship (Jazeera, Aug 18 strike / Aug 19 embargo response) — a one-day cross-outlet dating variance describing one event. Iran's foreign ministry denies responsibility, calling it a possible "false flag" attack.
- **CENTCOM's blockade/interdiction tally was climbing incrementally as of Aug 22** (68 vessels redirected vs. ~67 shortly before) — now superseded by this cycle's Aug 28 briefing above.
- **The Iran-Oman single-corridor deal remained unsigned as of Aug 22;** the underlying 60-day US-Iran negotiation window (from the June 17 Versailles MOU) expired Aug 17 without a confirmed deal.
- **Brent was ~\$93-95/bbl as of Aug 20-21,** a second straight weekly gain (~6%), the highest since late July — now reversed by this cycle's two-week Brent decline above.
- **Strait of Hormuz traffic: trackers disagreed on the exact daily transit count as of Aug 22** (estimates ranged ~1% to ~20% of the pre-war ~130-170/day baseline) — now superseded by the Aug 28 briefing above.

From the Aug 22 morning draft (score set 2026-08-22_draft) — carried forward, casualty framing softened above:

- ★ ★ **NEW — a fatal strike on the Hormuz tanker-attack campaign's latest victim (CORRECTED: not the first fatality, contrary to this draft's earlier framing).** The Liberia-flagged bulk carrier *Al Jazeera* was hit by a missile on Aug 21, corroborated by 7+ independent outlets (Maritime Executive, Windward, Hellenic Shipping News, Riviera, Safety4Sea, Splash247). No claim of responsibility yet. **Re-verified this cycle (draft Aug 22)** with new information, and a reason this cycle is left as a draft rather than auto-stamped.
- ★ ★ **NEW — the first Iranian vessel seizure since June 22.** The Liberia-flagged tanker *Amara* was boarded near Qeshm Island Aug 17; Iran's Fars News says it's held for non-payment under a 2015 UN Security Council resolution.
- ★ **Correction to the record:** the UAE missile-attack claim (Aug 18) remains single-source (UAE MoD only; Iran denies, calls it a possible "false flag") and is NOT the first direct attack on the UAE since the 2011-12 crisis.
- **No new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran since the Aug 1 stand-down** (GlobalSecurity Day-175 tracker) — the pause holds, a modest stabilizing factor.
- **Sanctions remain mostly rhetoric.** Treasury Secretary Bessent has repeatedly promised the "toughest sanctions in history" / to "collapse Iran's economy," with the actual package pushed to the Aug 24 deadline.
- **Brent ~\$93-95/bbl (Aug 21)** (TradingEconomics, Vantage, Fortune) — up modestly on sanctions anticipation, still well under the \$100 flip line.
- **Iran said Aug 22 it will allow Iraqi oil tankers through the Strait** (state media) — a mild, narrow normalizing signal amid otherwise hardening posture.
- **Mediation continues without a breakthrough;** Qatar/Oman still pushing diplomacy. Tehran "dismissed" Trump's sanctions threats Aug 21 and called the new sanctions a "declaration of war."
- **No new confirmed US combat death found in this window.**
- **BTC closed at \$77,169.40 on Aug 22** — up +7.4% from Aug 20's close of \$71,882.92 (Bitstamp). See The Claim for the honesty check on this divergence from the pillar's own evidence.

Carried forward from Aug 18-20 (still load-bearing — the UAE "novel escalation" framing is corrected above, not repeated here):

- **The UAE reported Iran fired two ballistic missiles at its territory Aug 18; Iran denies it, calling it a possible "false flag."** Bloomberg, CNN, and CP24 (Aug 18) report the UAE says one missile hit a ship in the Strait of Hormuz.
- **The UAE suspended all trade, commercial, and financial dealings with Iran, announced Aug 19** (CNN, Washington Post, Fortune) — a dated, corroborated, structural response, independent of the Aug 18 strike. *The embargo was initially flagged as a possible second incident by this cycle's adversarial pass — confirmed on reconciliation to be the same Aug 18 episode, not a new one.*
- **A commercial vessel was struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait, Aug 18,** causing engine damage and one crew injury (UK Maritime Trade Operations).
- **The Iran-Oman Hormuz route deal remains unsigned as of Aug 20-22.** Iran claims route coordinates were agreed Aug 18; Oman has not confirmed.

Carried forward from Aug 16-18 (independently re-verified against fresh primary sources this cycle — all confirmed accurate, still load-bearing):

- ★ **The 60-day MoU window formally lapsed Monday, Aug 18, without a signed deal.** CBS News's live desk (direct-fetched) reports the deadline expired that day; Iran's foreign ministry downplayed the significance, saying the talks were "very close." Trump told reporters he has "no time schedule" to resolve the conflict (a framing he softened, per above, on Aug 19).
- ★ **Trump threatened Oman.** In a Fox News interview (Aug 17, per CBS's live desk), Trump said the US would take action if Oman "gets in the way" of reopening the Strait, and that "we'd hand over the Strait."
- ★ **Strait of Hormuz traffic collapsed further.** CBS News's live desk, citing maritime monitors, reports only 3-5 vessel transits over the Aug 15-16 weekend, versus 31 the prior weekend; CENTCOM's Aug 18 briefing (score set 2026-08-22_draft2) notes a "collapse in traffic" — *the more defensible figure is closer to ~110/day. The discrepancy is flagged here for transparency; it does not change the direction or size of the collapse, which is stark under either baseline.*
- **Brent rose to ~\$90.9-91.0/bbl (Aug 17-18)** — up 2.7% on Aug 17 per Yahoo Finance/Fortune/TradingEconomics, from the \$87-90 range priced in Aug 13-16 — still well under the \$100 flip line.
- **BTC closed at \$64,285.10 on Aug 18** — +2.1% vs. Aug 16's close of \$62,937.03 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from Aug 14-16 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Three ADNOC tanker incidents in 48 hours (Aug 14-15), comparable in kind to the established pattern.** The UAE accused Iran/IRGC of striking two ADNOC vessels Aug 14 (Al Jazeera, Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera, and The Hill). The UAE Ministry called it "piracy." No new state targeted, no casualties at the time — now compounding into the Aug 18 shipping-collapse picture above.

Carried forward from Aug 11-14 (still load-bearing):

- **Aug 13 — Hormuz deal remains unsigned, stuck on hardened compensation demands from both sides.** Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera, and The Hill (six independent outlets) report a "deal" between Iran and the UAE, but only on the condition of a compensation demand to include damages "to the people of Lebanon, Syria, Yemen, and Gaza" — a hardening of the same dispute, not a new demand category.

- **Brent eased to ~\$87-90/bbl** (from the \$98-100+ spikes logged in late July) as Hormuz traffic stayed low as of Aug 13-14; a live tracker (straits.live) showed the Strait at "day 166" of closure.
- **Aug 13 — Araghchi again called the Hormuz deal "very close" while conditioning full reopening on the US "making amends" over the June MoU** (CNN, NPR, Al Jazeera, France 24).
- ★ **Aug 11 — a Houthi "double-tap" missile strike on the cargo vessel Tihamah in the Bab al-Mandeb Strait (Red Sea, not Hormuz) killed 6 (4 crew, 2 rescue workers)** per Yemeni gov't; a tanker hit and Aug 9 Jazan refinery strike already logged without moving P.
- **Iran's Supreme Leader reshuffled top military leadership (new armed-forces chief of staff, new IRGC commander)** — a structural development with an ambiguous, not-yet-legible direction.
- ★ **Houthi forces drone-struck Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery on Aug 9**, a 400,000 bpd facility on Saudi Arabia's Red Sea coast. NBC News, Al Jazeera, CBC, NPR, UPI, and Al Bawaba (Saudi).

Carried forward from Aug 8-10 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Iranian FM Araqchi says the Oman shipping-route deal is "very close" but conditions full reopening on new demands, including US compensation to Iran.** Reuters (via Investing.com) says the deal will only be implemented if it depends on further conditions, and that the previous shipping traffic separation scheme is "no longer acceptable to Tehran."
- ★ **The UAE says Iran struck another ship in the strait; Oman condemns "repeated attacks."** The same Reuters report: the UAE separately reported a fresh Iranian strike on a vessel transiting the Strait.

Carried forward from Aug 1-8 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Five separate Hormuz tanker/shipping incidents, Jul 31 - Aug 5, that daily two-day checks missed or undercounted.** The LNG carrier Gaslog Shanghai was struck and disabled carrying 120,000 cu m of gas; two more explosions were reported near Kumzar (Aug 5). The IMO's cumulative incident tally now stands at 65 since the war began (Bloomberg/UANI), with Hormuz traffic described as "at least partially closed."
- ★ ★ **NEW — a new front: Iran-backed Houthi forces struck Najran, Saudi Arabia on Aug 7**, wounding 11 civilians (7 Saudi, 1 Yemeni, 2 Egyptian, 1 Pakistani, including a 4-year-old with burns).
- ★ ★ **NEW — Saudi Arabia, Turkey, and Pakistan signed a mutual-defense "Mecca" pact on Aug 7** (an attack on one is an attack on all) — a structural, deterrence-oriented development that may be significant.
- **Aug 7-8 — Iran announced what it calls a finalized agreement with Oman on Hormuz shipping**, banning American and Israeli vessels and fining violators up to 20% of cargo value (IRNA). The fee/sovereignty dispute is unresolved, not narrowed. This claim's specific draft terms trace to Fars News (Iranian state media, citing one parliamentarian) and should be labeled Iran-sourced, not Omani.
- **Correction: Trump's Aug 2 "perimeters of a deal" framing was contested by his own later remarks.** Two days after claiming "the perimeters of a deal has been agreed to," Trump called the deal "a work in progress" paired with continuing attacks or contradictions within 1-2 days each time.
- **Brent held a \$82-86/bbl range through the week** — up modestly, not pricing a resolved crisis.
- **BTC closed at \$65,006.64 on Aug 8** — essentially flat vs. Aug 7's close of \$65,000.00.

Carried forward from Aug 1-7 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 7 — the Iran-Oman joint statement remained unsigned as of that check, still in final drafting.** Iran's Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei described the statement outlining agreed-on terms.

Carried forward from Aug 1-6 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 6 — Iran and Oman reached an "understanding in principle" on the Hormuz route map.** Iran's Deputy Foreign Minister Kazem Gharibabadi told IRNA: "an understanding in principle" was reached. Military.com.
- ★ **Aug 6 — the fee dispute first surfaced as the remaining obstacle.** Iran is seeking fees of 5-7% of cargo value from transiting ships; Oman is discussing fees around 3%; Washington wants 0%.

Carried forward from Aug 1-5 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Aug 1 — the first quiet night in days.** globalsecurity.org's day-by-day war tracker reported no new US strikes on Iran overnight Jul 31 following the heavy Jul 29-30 wave; Brent fell ~2% on the lull.
- ★ **Aug 1-2 — fresh, multi-source-corroborated attacks on Hormuz shipping.** Bloomberg: a Qatari LNG tanker (Gaslog Shanghai) was struck while transiting the Strait. UKMTO/globalsecurity.org: the pause was not durable.
- **Aug 2 — the Saudi-led naval coalition kept solidifying.** Al Jazeera, The National, DefenseMirror, and Tribune reported 14 confirmed member countries and 43 nations represented at a first meeting.
- ★ **Aug 4 — Trump canceled a planned joint US-Israeli strike on Iranian energy infrastructure.** Multiple outlets (NPR, Axios, Al Jazeera, NBC, Washington Times, Breitbart, JPost, Townhall) reported since the cancellation.
- **Aug 4 — Iran continues to deny any direct US talks.** Foreign Ministry spokesman Baghaei: "we currently have no negotiations with the United States; the negotiations are with Oman." Trump said he was "in touch" with the Saudis.
- ★ **Aug 4 — a bulker was struck by a projectile and suffered a full blackout in the Strait** (globalsecurity.org, iransitrep.com) — active attacks continued even as the diplomatic framework was being worked out.
- ★ **Aug 5 — the first public terms of a 60-day interim Hormuz deal.** Axios, Deccan Chronicle, Israel Hayom, InvestingLive, The National, and Al-Quds report the US, Iran, and Oman nearing agreement on a 60-day deal, with the US aiming to announce the deal Aug 6.
- **Aug 5 — still unsigned.** CNN quotes a Gulf official putting the odds of an Iran-Oman deal by Friday at only 50-50. The Strait remains formally impassable to normal traffic pending finalization.
- **BTC closed at \$64,661.55 on Aug 5** — up ~1.7% from the \$63,579.68 close on Jul 31, continuing its resilience through a week where the war's own risk signal moved both up and down.

Carried forward from the July 30 full refresh (still load-bearing):

- ★ **The lull was real, then it broke: Iran's IRGC struck a US/CENTCOM base at Muwaffaq Salti, Jordan (Jul 28).** Confirmed by 5+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, CNN, Axios, RT, JPost) — the same day Trump was publicly touting "very friendly" talks with Netanyahu at the White House — both things happened.
- ★ **The US retaliated with a "heavy wave of strikes" (Jul 29)** — explosions reported at Bandar Abbas, Kish Island, Qeshm Island, and Khuzestan Province (CNN). Trump: "it's our turn to hit them."
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Iraq: US and Saudi Arabia conducted joint strikes on Iran-backed Popular Mobilisation Forces across Iraq (Jul 29),** CENTCOM-confirmed, hitting sites in Baghdad, Vahdat, and Basra. Saudi Arabia's first turn as a direct co-belligerent in this war. A claim that "six Iranian IRGC advisors" were also killed is single-source (unnamed Iraqi militia officials) — flagged, not used.
- ★ **NEW FRONT — Egypt: a drone hit a US-owned FSRU vessel and a tanker at Egypt's Damietta port (Jul 29)** — the first strike on Egyptian soil in this war (Al Jazeera, CNBC, Times of Israel).
- **Brent rebounded from the lull-low.** Brent fell to ~\$90/bbl (-6.7%) during the Jul 25-27 lull, then rose back to ~\$92-93/bbl by Jul 30 (+~3.5% day-over-day, +24.6% month-over-month) on the lull.
- **Iran continues rejecting a direct-talks framing even as Trump claims progress.** Iran FM spokesman Baghaei, Jul 27: "We have no negotiations with the United States at present" — direct talks management proposal on Jul 28, insisting on controlling its own lane.
- **Congress split on competing War Powers resolutions (Jul 23, carried forward, no new action since):** House passed a nonbinding one 214-208 (4 GOP defectors); the Senate's binding one 68-32.
- ★ **The Pentagon casualty-count dispute (18 vs. 14) is confirmed stale, not a fresh Jul 30 event.** The DCAS toll briefly rose to 18 (Jul 23) then reverted to 14 (Jul 24) amid a credibly-sourced 24 CNBC article as if it were new; it is not.
- **Strait of Hormuz remains effectively closed to normal commercial traffic** — ~10 transits/day versus a normal baseline near 88/day (IMF PortWatch), unchanged from prior cycles. IRGC says it's "not a blockade."
- **No formal MoU withdrawal by either side.** The 60-day window to ~Aug 16 remains intact and un-triggered.
- **Israel remains out of direct engagement** — no confirmed direct Israel-Iran exchange since June 7-8; the widened fronts (Iraq, Egypt) involve the US, Saudi Arabia, and unclaimed actors, not Israel.
- **The "Layla" tanker claim (Jul 23) remains unconfirmed** after a full week — AIS data dark, no primary confirmation found. Downgraded from "watch" to "discard pending new evidence."
- **The baseline (still true, still load-bearing):** June 2025 "12-Day War" — BTC dipped to a ~\$98,225 intraday low, reclaimed \$107k+ within days, a fast V. The far larger 2026 war still hasn't started.

The Prize

Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice

The upside is still the **"buy-the-invasion" rebound**. Anchors: Russia–Ukraine (Feb 24, 2022) — BTC fell ~8% to a **~\$34,300 intraday low**, posted a +14.5% up-day on Feb 28, ended **~+25%** on Feb 29, and **~+30%** on Mar 1. The Aug 30–Sept 2 direct US–Iran exchange escalated sharply (a ~50x-larger US strike wave, the war's first direct strikes on Iranian government tankers, a four-country Iranian retaliation), retracted, but has not been confirmed reopened either. As of this cycle (Sept 19), the picture is mixed rather than clearly escalating further: Iran has gone nine straight days without striking, but the US has not yet responded. **\$81,224.46** on Sept 19, up sharply from \$78,046.80 on Sept 18 — this pillar's own P held flat this cycle, so that move tracks other pillars' news (notably nothing that cleared any pillar's own bias). The prize is unchanged in shape: a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both sides actually accept, signed and holding a full clean week without a new attack, fatality, or seizure, would shift the prize. That could move this either way — the Prize doesn't feed the math, it tells you what the lean is worth acting on.

The Other Side

The strongest honest case this is wrong

- **The cut may still be too small, even at 1/9/27/47/74.** Nearly 100 targets, the war's first direct tanker strikes, and a four-country simultaneous retaliation is a genuinely different order of magnitude. This scenario this pillar has always flagged as the real tail risk, and that keeping the cut "under 8 points per window" mechanically, out of habit from smaller prior incidents, is itself a mistake when the odds are this high.
- **Leaving it as a draft may itself be too cautious.** The independently-confirmed facts alone — CENTCOM's own ~100-target count, the first-ever tanker strikes, the four-country retaliation, the US's own source caveat as an excuse to soften a call the non-disputed facts already support, rather than a genuine evidentiary gap.
- **The cut may be too small.** This report explicitly pre-declared "a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper" as the line that breaks the dip-buy thesis — and calibrated the actual cut to a larger cut than a routine tanker incident, precisely because the report itself said in advance this class of event was different in kind, not just degree.
- **The cut may be too large.** One resumed-strike night after ~28-30 clean nights is, so far, a single interdiction event (stopping a mine-laying attempt) rather than evidence of a full campaign reinitiation. To follow in the next few days, this cut may prove to have moved faster than the evidence ultimately warranted.
- **The Oman corridor confirmation (Aug 25) is not retracted.** Oman's own Foreign Ministry still has not walked back its Aug 25 joint statement — the first time both parties on the "deal" side have done so in 1mo/3mo-scoped shock.
- **The Aug 24 sanctions package is arguably a bigger structural story than this week's kinetic exchange.** It was the first Iran sanctions action in this war to explicitly name digital assets and the US's own source caveat as an excuse to soften a call the non-disputed facts already support, rather than a genuine evidentiary gap.
- **No confirmed US casualty, still.** The single hardest-edged clause of this pillar's own flip line — a confirmed new US combat death — remains unfired even after this week's exchange; a real one would shift the prize.
- **Thin sample, still.** The bullish long-term read rests on a handful of dip-and-recover events, all in a bull regime — geopolitical shocks don't always V-recover, and a fresh direct strike exchange would shift the prize.
- **Two more restraint signals landed this cycle, logged honestly — a reader could argue they're under-weighted.** The BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12) — signed by the US — describes the Houthis privately signaling they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen. Neither moves P (one is purely diplomatic, the other single-source as to substance), but this pillar looms large in each individual scoring decision is defensible.

The Triggers

Dated events ahead — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. **As of Sept 26 (full weekly refresh):** re-verified the WSJ Trump-rejects-Hormuz story and the Reuters still-talking story already priced into the same-day escalation type. No flip-line clause newly fires; P HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66, left as draft for Alex's manual review. **As of Sept 19 (full weekly refresh):** the Togo-flagged tanker "Trend" strike is now CONFIRMED (reversing the process continues moving but remains unenacted (new row below); and the UN Security Council failed 11-2-2 on Sept 17 to renew its Iran-sanctions monitoring panel — institutional gridlock, a new row below. None of this clear. **NOT USED** — see the top rows. As of Sept 16, 2026: the IAEA's UNSC referral (Sept 9) and the 130-lawmaker NPT-withdrawal push (Sept 12-13) are the newest entries, driving this cycle's 6/12/36mo re-rate down. Re-leveled independent outlets; escalation continued sharply Sept 1-2 — a materially larger strike wave and a four-country retaliation; the Sept 5 tanker strike is CENTCOM-CONFIRMED and revealed to be part of a direct IRGC missile attack on Sept 9 for the first time since July 24; the IRGC retaliates for that strike by hitting Jordan's Al Azraq air base Sept 9, and Houthi forces seize the Yemeni port of Mocha Sept 10 closing in on Bab el-Mandeb. **As of Sept 11 a SECOND round of strikes on Yemen's Red Sea coastline and seized Bab al-Mandeb's Mayyun Island** — a second global chokepoint moving from "closing in on" to actual island-level control, though it does not independently fire a fresh flip-line clause (see the top rows). **Salalah, Oman on Monday Sept 14 on Strait of Hormuz navigation, safe shipping routes and mine clearance — the first such gathering since the war began in February (Iranian MFA statement, primary, plus 6+ independent outlets)** **managing a strait Iran still controls, and continued fighting on Sept 13 (a fatal vessel attack near Qeshm Island, a Houthi projectile on Jazan, ongoing Bab al-Mandeb combat).** **It does NOT fire the upside flip line** Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline) Sept 10 (Saudi MFA statement Sept 11), sponsorship undetermined (Trump's "probably Iran" is a single hedged remark) — neither the widening clause (Iraq is existing theater) nor the US

DATE	EVENT
Sept 24-26, CONFIRMED via 4+ independent outlets — full weekly refresh, no P move	Continued Houthi (Iran-aligned) missile/drone attacks on Saudi Arabia — intercepted, no confirmed casualties (Bloomberg, Al Jazeera)
Sept 17, reported Sept 17-18; UPCOMING Tuesday Sept 22 — dated, multi-sourced (Axios original, plus Jerusalem Post, Politico/Political Wire, Israel National News, Common Dreams, Breitbart, CBN News — 5+ independent)	Trump told Axios he faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime or not , ahead of a Tuesday Sept 22 UN Security Council meeting (Kuwait, Oman)
Struck Sept 17-18 — CONFIRMED via IRGC's own statement (IRNA, primary, via GlobalSecurity.org reprint) plus independent outlets (The Hill, Bernama, IranWire, TFTC, Parapolitika, Rio Times)	The IRGC struck the Togo-flagged tanker "Trend" in the Strait of Hormuz on Sept 17-18; crew reported safe, no confirmed spill; no CENTCOM confirmation
Sept 7-13, still unenacted as of Sept 19 — corroborated but mostly Iran-linked/state-affiliated (Iran International, Tehran Times, IranWire, APA.az, anews, Militarnyi, IFP News)	Iran's parliament continues moving toward, but has NOT enacted, NPT withdrawal: 130 lawmakers signed a further Sept 7-13 statement; Goudarzi said withdrawal "can easily" be done; a bill was submitted for expedited consideration but not yet voted on or enacted, and Iran's parliament is expected to vote on it soon
Sept 18 — PRIMARY (UN press releases sc16455 and related) plus Euronews and Security Council Report's monthly forecast	The UN Security Council failed 11-2-2 (Russia and China vetoing) to renew its panel of independent experts monitoring reimposition of sanctions the ongoing Russia/China-vs-E3 legal dispute over the 2025 "snapback" sanctions reimposition
FIRE d Sept 9, reported Sept 12-16 — PRIMARY (IAEA Board of Governors institutional action)	The IAEA Board of Governors voted to refer Iran's nuclear file to the UN Security Council , escalating international pressure over Iran's nuclear program; IAEA signed a statement Sept 12-13 calling on parliament to begin the legal process for NPT withdrawal, with a hardline MP saying an emergency session is needed; Counterweight: President Pezeshkian publicly reiterated Iran is not seeking nuclear weapons; the Foreign Ministry says the withdrawal is a bluff
FIRE d Sept 13 — PRIMARY (Oman News Agency statement) plus 5+ independent outlets (Arab News, Washington Post, CNN, Gulf News, Malay Mail)	The Salalah ministerial was POSTPONED, one day before it was to convene, with NO new date. ONA: the meeting is "postponed to a later date" but explicitly ruled out attending; no GCC state had confirmed; the UAE had downgraded to a minister of state. Iran's MFA says Saudi Arabia's officials, reported not scored. Separately, FM Araqchi said the Iran-Oman understanding "would not mean reopening of the Strait of Hormuz" but it was not scored.
Announced Fri Sept 11, reported Sept 11-12 — PRIMARY (Iranian MFA statement) plus 6+ independent outlets; SUPERSEDED — the meeting was postponed Sept 13, see the row above	First Iran-GCC ministerial meeting since the war began in February. The foreign ministers of Iran, the six GCC states and Iraq convened to discuss shipping routes, mine clearance and short-term management of the waterway, built on weeks of Oman-mediated Iran-Oman talks. Iranian officials said the meeting "will help strengthen shared regional security" (Al Jazeera Sept 11, Dawn Sept 12, Arab News, Oman Observer, The Business Standard, etc.) but it will not attend; an Iranian official told JPost no signed deal is expected; Tehran is weighing a transit service-fee regime, i.e. the agenda is not scored.
Sept 13, reported same day (Al Jazeera live blog) — Iran's attribution is Iran's own and is NOT treated as established	A commercial vessel was attacked near Qeshm Island inside the Strait of Hormuz, killing one and wounding four; an Iranian official blamed the attack on Houthi forces, damaging a mosque. Houthi forces and Yemen's internationally recognised government continued trading strikes over Bab al-Mandeb
Friday Sept 11 — a market price, reported NOT used to move P	Brent gave back 4.24% to ~\$104.26, the first meaningful downside session since the sustained->\$100 flip-line clause fired; wire coverage (TradingEconomics, Forbes)
Attack Sept 10, Saudi MFA statement/confirmation Sept 11 (primary) plus 6+ independent outlets — sponsorship UNDETERMINED (Iraqi-origin, no group claim)	Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline) — its primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route — hit by drones launched from Iran, causing significant material damage, will not retaliate for now at Baghdad's request (Al Jazeera, CNBC, CNN, Times of Israel, ABC News Australia, Oil & Gas World, Shalamcheh border crossing. Trump (Dublin): Iran "probably" responsible — single, hedged, unconfirmed, NOT treated as fact
Fired Sept 10-11, escalated to island seizure Sept 11, CONFIRMED via 6+ independent outlets — no strait closure yet	Houthi forces complete their sweep of Yemen's entire Red Sea coastline (capturing Dhubab, Murad) and seize Mayyun (Perim) Island (Al Jazeera, News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald). Saudi Crown Prince MBS's request for direct US strikes on the Houthis was refused
Sept 10 (UKMTO Warning 133-26, issued 1910 UTC), reported Sept 11 — CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus 3+ independent outlets	Four unidentified projectiles struck two vessels ~4nm west of Khasab, Oman, setting one afire (UKMTO; Gulf News, Maritime Executive); separate IRGC claim of a strike on a US Navy Saildrone near the Strait entrance, no US/CENTCOM confirmation
FIRE d Sept 10-11 — a flip-line clause, CONFIRMED via 4+ independent market sources	"Sustained Brent close above \$100" — Brent ended Thursday Sept 10 up more than 6% above \$107 (above \$108 intraday), its highest since July 24, ~\$104.36 midday Friday Sept 11, ~9% higher on the week (Rigzone/Bloomberg wire, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500). Thursday's level — an intraday read, not the close
Fired Sept 9, fuller reporting landed Sept 10-11, CONFIRMED via 4 independent outlets (Reuters wire)	Iran attacked 10 vessels near the Strait of Hormuz — 2 US-linked ships and 8 oil tankers — the largest declared wave of shipping attacks since 2011 (Reuters via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill)
Fired Sept 9, CONFIRMED via CENTCOM/Jordan's own military statement plus multi-outlet reporting	IRGC retaliates for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike by firing 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base — Jordan's MFA says it was hit (Al Jazeera, MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org Day 194, Jordan's own military statement)
Fired Sept 10, CONFIRMED via 5+ independent outlets — chokepoint NOT yet closed	Iran-aligned Houthi forces seize the Yemeni Red Sea port city of Mocha, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — a second global chokepoint (Al Jazeera, South China Morning Post, Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail)
Second straight session, logged Sept 10 — SUPERSEDED by the Sept 10-11 firing above	Brent crude trades near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session — above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9 for the first time since May 2025 (Thursday closed above \$107)
Crossed intraday Sept 9, CONFIRMED via CNBC and ABC News — NOT a sustained close	Brent crude tops \$100/bbl intraday for the first time since July 24 , trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil price worries;" (ABC News)
Fired Sept 8, CONFIRMED via CENTCOM's own press release plus 5+ independent outlets	CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon, M/T Al-Nasr, M/T Al-Nasr Navy warship with ballistic missiles TWICE over the preceding two days ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another Ship")

	corroborating)
Announced Sept 6-7, on-record, corroborated by 8+ independent outlets — NOT yet executed	Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announces Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" beginning at the US Navy's blockade on Iran's sanctions list; he separately says an Iran-Oman corridor agreement will be signed "in the coming days" (Press TV, Tehran Times)
Fired Sept 5, CONFIRMED Sept 6 via CENTCOM's own press release plus 5+ independent outlets	CENTCOM confirms US forces struck THREE Iranian crude oil tankers Sept 5 — M/T Downy (disabled, Kharg Island), M/T Stark and ballistic missiles at two US Navy warships (a carrier and a guided-missile destroyer), both of which evaded; no US personnel harmed
Claimed Sept 6, single-source (IRGC) — NOT independently used to move P	Iran's IRGC claims further strikes on three more tankers plus three "US-linked" vessels, and a strike on a US naval drone enter
Fired Sept 3, CONFIRMED — repeat targets, widening clause did NOT fire	Iran fired a second retaliatory wave on Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE) — a US official confirmed no US-mar
Fired Sept 1-2, CONFIRMED via 9 independent outlets	CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes hit nearly 100 targets across Iran — IRGC air-defense sites, radar, mine-laying capability, comms (Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI)
Fired Sept 1-2, CONFIRMED, novel	For the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms) under a newly reported "tanker
Reported Sept 1-2, SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact — NOT independently used to move P	A US strike on Kuestak, Hormozgan reportedly hit a wedding party — Hormozgan governor's office: 4 of at least 5 dead (incl. a 4-
Fired Sept 2, CONFIRMED via multi-source reporting — widening clause did NOT fire	IRGC coordinated ballistic-missile/drone strikes on US-linked bases in FOUR countries at once: Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait
Fired Aug 31, CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus multi-source reporting	A THIRD Hormuz tanker hit this week: the Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity struck by three unknown projectiles ~17nm north of priced Metro Venetian (Aug 24) and Al Salam II (Aug 25)
Claimed Aug 31, DISPUTED target / CONFIRMED incursion	Iran's army claims a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base; UAE MoD DENIES the base was targeted while CONFIRMING
Fired Aug 31, on-record — not a de-escalation signal	President Trump said on-record he is still weighing further strikes on Iran , calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart)
Fired Aug 30, CONFIRMED — FLIP LINE TRIGGERED	Resumption of direct US strikes on Iranian territory: CENTCOM struck two IRGC rocket/mine-launchers on Larak Island after observed night clean streak; corroborated by 20+ outlets plus on-record CENTCOM spokesperson Capt. Tim Hawkins
Fired Aug 30-31, CONFIRMED (Iran-claimed damage NOT independently confirmed)	IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on two US-linked Jordan airbases (King Hussein, Al-Azraq) — Jordan's military intercepted confirmed US casualty
Fired Aug 24, CONFIRMED via direct fetch — re-verified Aug 29	"Operation Economic Outcast" sanctions package — home.treasury.gov sb0613/sb0614, OFAC recent-actions entry 20260824; ~60 digital assets named a sanctionable sector, 30 crypto addresses (BTC/ETH/TRON) listed; corroborated by state.gov, TRM Labs, Chainalysis
Fired Aug 25, CONFIRMED via direct fetch — re-verified Aug 29	Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor — fm.gov.om/en/53722; 7-mile joint navigational corridor permanent corridor per the "Islamabad Memorandum"; still explicitly "temporary," no fee terms disclosed; Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait
Fired Aug 24 & Aug 27, re-verified Aug 29	Two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents: Aug 24, off Oman's coast, engine-room damage, vessel disabled, no casualty; incident's attribution confirmed by any party.
Fired Aug 25, re-verified Aug 29 — real but NOT durable	Trump announced the Strait of Hormuz "has been demined" and declared a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines, backed by Space Force; tanker incident above landed two days later, undercutting durability
Aug 28, CONFIRMED — re-verified Aug 29	CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing: Iranian sea mines cleared from the internationally-recognized shipping lanes; disabled for evasion; no Iranian oil exports since blockade resumed (UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire)
Aug 28 IMO briefing, quasi-primary, corroborated by 4 outlets	Six-month casualty count settles at 19-20 dead across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the previously-reported 15-19 range
Week of Aug 17-23, reported Aug 21 & Aug 28 (USNI News/Lloyd's List)	First confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week, 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week (westbound)
Claimed Aug 26, single-source, NOT USED — re-checked Aug 29	IRGC spokesman claims Iran and Oman agreed to share Hormuz revenue and delineate waters (Sepah News, Iranian state military); did NOT confirm it, the two countries' own joint statement described only an "interim framework" with no mention of fees, and the IRGC's
Checked Aug 27 — GlobalSecurity Day-181 tracker	28th consecutive night with no confirmed US/CENTCOM strike on Iran
Checked directly Aug 22-29 — no new event	No new confirmed US combat death. One initial-looking hit (Sgt. Michael Emmanuel Swinton) was actually killed Jul 18-19, already confirmed
Fired Aug 17-18 — CONFIRMED, negative, but CORRECTED framing, toll RE-VERIFIED as a range	Fatal strike in the tanker-attack campaign: bulker Minoan Dignity struck, chief engineer killed
Fired Aug 17, held to Aug 19 — CONFIRMED, negative, cleared the bar	First Iranian vessel seizure since June 22: tanker Amara boarded near Qeshm Island, held under Iran's post-MoU toll regime
Fired Aug 18 — CONFIRMED reported, DISPUTED attribution, single-source; RECONCILED this cycle	The UAE reports Iran fired two ballistic missiles at its territory , one landing in territorial waters; Iran denies involvement, calls it a possible
Announced Aug 19 — CONFIRMED, negative, structural	The UAE suspended all trade, commercial, and financial dealings with Iran

Reported Aug 20, still unsigned as of Aug 22 draft2 — continuation, not yet resolved	The Iran-Oman Hormuz route deal remains unsigned ; Iran claims coordinates agreed Aug 18, Oman has not confirmed
No new incident, checked Aug 19-22 — draft2 finding	Independent re-check for any new vessel strike, seizure, or Iran-related military incident, Aug 19-22
Fired Aug 18 — CONFIRMED, negative, cleared the bar	The 60-day MoU window formally lapsed without a signed deal ; Iran says the US breached it first, Trump says "no time schedule" (see below)
Fired Aug 17, logged Aug 18 — CONFIRMED, negative, new target named	Trump threatened Oman ("we'd handle them very easily") if it "gets in the way" of reopening the Strait
Reported Aug 17-18 — CONFIRMED, negative	Strait of Hormuz traffic collapsed to 3-5 weekend transits vs. 31 the prior weekend vs. ~110/day pre-war baseline (re-checked; see below)
Fired Aug 18, logged Aug 20 — negative, isolated so far	A commercial vessel struck by an unknown projectile in the Strait , engine damage, one crew injury
Fired Aug 14-15, logged Aug 16 — continuation, now compounding	Three ADNOC tanker incidents (two Aug 14, one Aug 15) — no injuries, UAE/IRGC attribution, no direct Iranian claim
Reported Aug 13 — continuation, not escalation	Hormuz deal remains unsigned; both sides' compensation demands harden (Reuters, US News, NBC, Washington Post, Al Jazeera)
Fired Aug 11, logged Aug 12 — continuation, not escalation	Houthi "double-tap" strike on the cargo vessel Tihamah (Bab al-Mandeb Strait, Red Sea) — 6 killed
Fired Aug 9, found Aug 11 — continuation, not escalation	Houthi drone strike on Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery (400,000 bpd) — no injuries, fire extinguished same-day
Reported Aug 8-9 — continuation, not escalation	Iranian FM Araqchi calls the Oman deal "very close" but adds a US-compensation demand ; UAE reports another ship hit; Oman closed to shipping
Jul 31 - Aug 5 — CONFIRMED, negative, missed by daily checks	Five separate Hormuz tanker/shipping incidents (Gaslog Shanghai, Oman-side explosion, Minoan Pioneer, two Kumzar explosions)
Fired Aug 7 — CONFIRMED, negative, new front	Iran-backed Houthi forces struck Najran, Saudi Arabia , wounding 11 civilians — the conflict's first widening to a fourth state
Pending — the real trigger	Whether a fee/compensation/sovereignty compromise both Iran and the US can accept is actually signed AND holds through a crisis
Structural, ongoing	Saudi-led Multinational Maritime Defense Alliance plus the new Aug 7 Saudi-Turkey-Pakistan mutual-defense pact
By Dec 31, 2026	Final US–Iran nuclear deal signed — not fired, pending
PARTIALLY FIRED Sept 22, 2026 — corroborated 6+ independent outlets plus Iranian state media; REVERSED Sept 25-26, see row below	US (Witkoff/Kushner) and Iran (FM Araghchi) held a 3-hour mediated meeting at the UN General Assembly sidelines — Trump called it "a very near future." Separately, a senior Iranian official told Reuters (Sept 22, corroborated 8+ outlets) Iran can reopen Hormuz within 7 days if US returns Iranian assets and ending the war on named "resistance fronts."
REVERSED Sept 25-26, 2026 — WSJ (citing US officials) widely syndicated 20+ outlets, plus CNN's own separate reporting and on-record White House officials	Trump REJECTED Iran's 7-day Hormuz proposal and told aides he expects US bombing of Iran to resume after the November 15 election (see below). Al Arabiya, Breitbart, The National, Japan Times, Mediaite). CNN's own Sept 25 analysis separately calls Iran's offer "a non-starter"; senior US officials, including the State Dept. (Sept 25), see it as a "counterweight." Counterweight, also new: Reuters (Sept 26, citing a US official) reports talks are still "positive, constructive" through mediators; Al Jazeera (Sept 26) says a "preliminary" deal was under discussion before the WSJ story broke.

The flip line, re-leveled — TRIGGERED Aug 30, and as of Sept 11 a SECOND distinct clause (sustained Brent close above \$100) has now ALSO fired: a confirmed new US combat death, a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper” clause fired — CENTCOM struck Larak Island, the first acknowledged US strike on Iranian territory since Jul 29. As of Sept 11, the “sustained Brent close above \$100” clause widened to a further new state with confirmed attribution) are not. As of Sept 1-2, the strikes clause was already firing again at vastly greater scale — CENTCOM confirms nearly 100 targets struck (~50x US casualty found as of this run); the widening-to-a-further-new-state clause did NOT fire despite Iran’s Sept 2 retaliation hitting four countries simultaneously (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait) — every one of the four is nonetheless the largest single-cycle escalation since the flip line itself fired, which is why P moved sharply down that cycle. UPDATE, Sept 6: CENTCOM has now confirmed the Sept 5 tanker strike this pillar had clauses (no confirmed US casualty, no confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, Brent short of \$100) — the cut this cycle is modest (no window moved >2 points) and, unlike the Sept 2 cycle, is AUTO-STAMPE attack, fatality, or seizure. Oman’s own government confirmed a temporary corridor Aug 25, but the confirmed direct US-Iran naval exchange makes a durable, US-accepted deal considerably further away, not a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state, or a sustained Brent close above \$100 — any of which would independently fire a fresh flip-line clause and likely warrant a larger cut. UPDATE, Sept 8: Iran’s SNSC set independent outlets, but explicitly not yet executed (no boundaries announced, no confirmed incident tied to it). This does not independently re-fire any of the three unfired clauses (no confirmed US casualty, no confirmed US casualty, no confirmed US casualty). CENTCOM confirms a FIVE-tanker strike Sept 8 (M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco, M/T Derya) in retaliation for a second IRGC missile attack on a US Navy warship — a repeat pattern, not a “>\$100” clause, but an intraday cross is explicitly not a sustained close, so that clause does not fire either. None of the three unfired clauses independently re-fires this cycle — the cut is modest (no window moved >1 point), but is actually declared and enforced, whether the Iran-Oman corridor deal is actually signed, a confirmed US combat death, or a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state. UPDATE, Sept 10: the IRGC retaliates for Mandeb — a second chokepoint, but the same actor/theater already priced, and no strait closure has actually been confirmed, so this doesn’t fire a clause either. Brent now trades above \$100 for a second straight day, independently re-fires this cycle — the cut is modest (no window moved >1 point) and is AUTO-STAMPED per the delegated daily authority. UPDATE, Sept 12: the Houthis have now gone further than “closing in on Bab al-Mandeb”, but they haven’t fired yet. Still, no strait CLOSURE or shipping interdiction has actually been executed by the Houthis, so the widening clause does not fire (same actor/theater), and no US casualty is confirmed, so that clause doesn’t fire either. Watch next cycle for: whether the Houthis actually close or interdict shipping through Bab al-Mandeb (vs. merely holding its shores/islands), whether Zuqar Island’s contested status resolves, a confirmed US casualty on Iranian territory Sept 10 (Saudi MFA statement Sept 11) — does not independently fire either the widening clause (Iraq is existing theater, active since the Sept 1 Erbil strike) or the US-casualty clause (none confirmed); if manual review regardless of the move’s size — full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority. Watch next cycle for: whether responsibility for the pipeline strike is claimed on none of the four clauses newly fires this cycle. Iran’s parliament still has not enacted NPT withdrawal (proposal-stage only); Trump’s Sept 17 “big decision” remark remains rhetoric about an undated future action, not a confirmed US casualty, war; the “Trend” tanker strike (Sept 17-18) is newly confirmed but is a continuation of the already-priced tanker campaign, not a widening or a fresh casualty; and Brent eased to ~\$103.21/bbl Sept 18, still elevated. Watch next cycle for: whether the UN Security Assembly Gulf-states meeting, whether the NPT-withdrawal bill is actually voted on, a confirmed US combat death, or a confirmed strike on a genuinely new state. UPDATE, Sept 26: WSJ reports (widely syndicated) that CENTCOM does NOT independently fire the “resumption of direct US strikes” clause (which requires an actual strike, not a stated expectation of one). None of the four clauses newly fires this cycle. Watch next cycle for: whether

My Decision

DRAFT — SEPTEMBER 26, 2026 (2026-09-26_draft2) · FULL WEEKLY REFRESH · AWAITING MY STAMP · THIS PILLAR HELD FLAT

P (2026-09-26_draft2, DRAFT, FULL WEEKLY REFRESH — HELD FLAT): 1 / 1 / 14 / 33 / 66 · Prior committed P (2026-09-26_draft, light daily touch, unchanged): 1mo -4.70 · 3mo -5.10 · 6mo -4.03 (Strong Bear) · 1yr -1.77 (Bear) · 3yr +1.41 (Mild Bull) · Master (equal-weight), as of this cycle's bleed-out. Leave-one-out without this pillar: +0.62 (equal-weight) — Fed & Macro is the pillar that moved this cycle; see that report

Sept 26 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-26_draft2), this version: independently re-verified the WSJ Trump-rejects-Hormuz-proposal story and the Reuters still-"positive, constructive"-talks story. Arabia Sept 24-26 (intercepted, no confirmed casualties; 4+ independent outlets) are a continuation of the already-priced Aug 7 fourth-state widening, not a new escalation bar, so the widening flip-line clause found anywhere. Brent ~\$105/bbl Sept 25, still inside the already-fired sustained->\$100 band, not a new threshold event. **No flip-line clause newly fires; sufficiency bar not cleared for any further move for Alex's manual review.** Fed & Macro is the only pillar that moved this cycle (a genuinely new primary-sourced cluster the daily touches missed) — see that report; CLARITY Act and Tokenization were not.

Sept 26 LIGHT DAILY touch (score set 2026-09-26_draft, prior version — reversing the Sept 23 re-rate back to the Sept 22 baseline: the Wall Street Journal reported Sept 25-26 (citing US officials) that the White House officials on the record confirming the administration has "no intention of dismantling its maritime blockade," betting sustained economic pressure forces Tehran into a worse deal — this clears the actual resumption of strikes — "after the midterms" is prospective, roughly six-plus weeks out, and outside this pillar's flip-line clauses of a confirmed new US combat death, resumption of direct strikes on Iran, or constructive" discussions through mediators on the nuclear file; US News (Sept 24, before the WSJ story broke) reported the two sides were discussing a phased deal to reopen Hormuz and end the blockade. **credibly and multiply contradicted, so that bump is reversed; the situation has not deteriorated further than the pre-Sept-22 baseline because talks and mediation are still reported ongoing in the region** (reversing the prior bump). Research capability fully available this cycle — WebSearch clean throughout, no EGRESS_BLOCKED hits. This is an ordinary light daily touch, no window moved more than 2 points (equal-weighted) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)." CLARITY Act, Tokenization, and Fed & Macro**

Sept 23 LIGHT DAILY touch (score set 2026-09-23_draft, prior version — the first upward re-rate on this pillar since Sept 13: two dated, well-corroborated diplomatic developments Sept 22, 2026 — Iran's proposal was reportedly delivered to the US via mediators on Sept 16. Corroborated independently by 8+ outlets carrying the Reuters wire (Washington Times, Yahoo, US News, The Star, etc.) **mediated meeting at the UN General Assembly sidelines in New York, Sept 22**, the first reported direct-channel US-Iran contact at this level since the war began. Trump called it "a very good meeting, but not a deal" (Sept 22). (The UN Security Council failed 11-2-2 on Sept 17 (Kuwait, etc.) of Israel, New Arab, Al Arabiya) plus independent confirmation from Iranian state media of the Araghchi-Witkoff meeting itself — not a single-source claim. **Sized like the Sept 13 precedent** (a comparable "resistance front" Tehran names — a wide gap from a signed deal; President Pezeshkian is in New York but will explicitly NOT meet Trump directly, so this remains a working-level channel; Sept 21 brought the news that Iran's Parliament Speaker Ghalibaf said Iran will not return to talks until US demands are met is flagged, not used, per the sufficiency rule — as is a SINGLE-SOURCE Sept 23 report of new US sanctions on Iran, genuinely new state, sustained Brent close above \$100) is independently fired or un-fired either way. Context, not scored: Brent crude fell to ~\$99/bbl by Sept 22, a 5th straight down session and 2-week low, estimated 6-8 weeks (Reuters via multiple outlets) — both directionally consistent with, but not independently used to justify, this re-rate. **P RE-RATED UP, modestly: 1mo 1 → 3, 3mo 1 → 3, 6mo 14 → 16, 1yr 1 → 1, 3yr 1 → 1**, an ordinary light daily touch, no window moved more than 2 points, sourcing clears the primary-source-plus-multi-outlet bar, and the master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral equal-weighted). Tokenization, and Fed & Macro all held flat on independent re-check this cycle — see those reports.

Sept 19 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-19_draft, prior version: a full independent primary-source research pass across all five windows, against the last committed baseline (2026-09-18_draft2) statement (Sept 7-13) urged the legal Article X process, Parliament Presidium spokesman Abbas Goudarzi said withdrawal "can easily" be done, and a bill was submitted for expedited consideration — but the bill faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime ahead of a Tuesday Sept 22 UN General Assembly sideline meeting with six Gulf-state leaders (Saudi Arabia, UAE, Qatar, Bahrain, Kuwait, etc.) term windows already at this pillar's practical floor. **The Sept 22 meeting is flagged as this pillar's clearest near-term trigger to watch next cycle.** The UN Security Council failed 11-2-2 on Sept 17 (Kuwait, etc.) — institutional gridlock over the 2025 snapback dispute, not a new sanction or act of war. The Togo-flagged tanker "Trend" strike (Sept 17-18), which last cycle's targeted search could not corroborate, is not a FIRED call, but it is a continuation of an already-months-long tanker campaign, not a new escalatory step, so it updates the record without moving P. Brent settled ~\$103.21/bbl Sept 18 (CNBC, Al Jazeera, etc.) — an escalatory data point — while a Houthi-linked air-raid alert hit Riyadh Sept 19 for the first time since July (Times of Israel liveblog) — a mixed signal; neither clears the bar. FM Araghchi said Iran and Oman are in talks (corroborated by Samaa) — a net wash. **P HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66.** Research capability was NOT degraded this cycle — full WebSearch access, 10+ independent outlets plus primary UN/IRGC statement. **This set is a FULL WEEKLY refresh — categorically excluded from delegated daily auto-stamp authority regardless of the size of the move (here, zero) — LEFT AS DRAFT: status draft, NOT stamped, NOT fired.**

Sept 18 LIGHT DAILY touch (score set 2026-09-18_draft, prior cycle: two dated items were found and weighed. Trump told Axios Sept 17 he faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime (Sept 17) (anews — 5+ independent), but it is rhetoric about an undated future decision, and the near-term windows (1mo/3mo P=1) already price maximal active-war uncertainty, so it does not clear the bar for a further move. This is from any named outlet or primary (CENTCOM/IRGC) source — **treated as NOT FIRED / NOT USED**, the same house discipline this report has applied to every other uncorroborated single claim (e.g., Sept 17). Tokenization RWA is the only pillar that moved this cycle — see that report.

Prior cycle (Sept 17 light daily touch): re-checked — no new dated development beyond the Sept 9 IAEA referral and the Sept 12-13 NPT statement already priced. **P HELD FLAT. AUTO-STAMPED SEPT 17.**

Sept 14 LIGHT DAILY touch (score set 2026-09-15_draft, this version — yesterday's up-move is retraced, because the meeting it rested on was called off: the Salalah ministerial never convened (Sept 14) (the Washington Post, CNN, Gulf News and Malay Mail. Bahrain had ruled out attending, no GCC state had confirmed, and the UAE had downgraded its representation; Iran's MFA blames a Saudi request for a meeting. The news — a market price, reported not scored. **P RE-RATED DOWN to 1/1/18/38/70** (1mo -2, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -1, 36mo flat). This is an ordinary light daily touch, research access was full, and Sept 14 is a firm new date with Saudi and Bahraini attendance confirmed would re-fire the de-escalation read faster than it retraced.

Sept 13 LIGHT DAILY touch (score set 2026-09-13_draft, prior cycle — the first UPWARD re-rate on this pillar since August 6, now superseded by the postponement above: ONE sufficiency-clearing event, **Salalah, Oman on Monday Sept 14 to discuss navigation through the Strait of Hormuz** — specifically safe and temporary commercial shipping routes, mine clearance, and short-term management of the strait. Iranian MFA's own statement, describing the gathering as an effort "to promote better understanding among the countries of the region and help strengthen shared regional security." Corroborated by 6+ independent outlets. **new and dated, are logged and sized in — they are why this is +2 points and not a reversal:** (1) Bahrain announced Sept 12 it will NOT attend, so GCC participation is incomplete; (2) an Iranian official said the gathering is a service-free regime for transiting vessels, which arguably institutionalises rather than lifts the blockade; (4) the kinetic war did not pause — on Sept 13 a commercial vessel was attacked near Qatar. Saudi Arabia causing injuries and damaging a mosque, and Houthi forces continued trading strikes with Yemen's internationally recognised government over Bab al-Mandeb (Al Jazeera live blog, Sept 13). **Sept 13 is fired** — attributed by wire coverage to this diplomacy plus the already-logged IEA demand forecast. **No flip-line clause fires in either direction.** The downside clauses already fired (direct US strikes on Iran, etc.) accepted Hormuz reopening that holds a full clean week. An announced meeting at which no deal is expected is not that. **P RE-RATED UP, modestly, to 3/3/19/39/70** (from 1/1/17/37/70) — 1mo +2, 3mo +2, 6mo +2, 12mo +2, 36mo +2, against the 1-to-2-point daily cuts this pillar has been taking all month. **Auto-stamp decision:** this is an ordinary light daily touch, research capability (WebSearch/WebFetch, primary sources) was fully available, size, call-band movement, and how novel the news feels are no longer grounds to withhold — **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)".** The *direction* of the move is not scored.

Sept 12 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-12_draft2), prior version — still DRAFT, awaiting Alex's manual review: four parallel adversarial research passes ran across all four qualitative pillars. Risk found ONE sufficiency-clearing new fact beyond the morning baseline: **Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline) — its primary Hormuz-bypass oil-export route — was hit by drones launched from Yemen** (Sept 12) (Reuters, etc.) Affairs confirmed pumping stations near Riyadh/Medina were struck, causing injuries and material damage, and said it would not retaliate for now at Baghdad over Bab al-Mandeb (Al Jazeera live blog, Sept 13). **Sept 12 is fired** — commander, and closing the Shalamchah border crossing. **Attribution caveat:** no group has claimed responsibility, and the Saudi MFA statement attributes origin only to Iraqi territory, not to a directing state (Iraq has been an active theater since the Sept 1 IRGC strike on US facilities in Erbil province — this is escalation within an existing theater, not a new one); the US-casualty clause does NOT fire (no confirmed deaths, account that the Houthis privately signaled they don't want direct US involvement in Yemen (single-source as to substance, consistent with the already-logged MBS-refused-strikes counterweight), and the Sept 12 al-Mandeb seizure was independently re-verified as still holding (Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, ZeroHedge). **P RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/14/34/66**, are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of move size or how the sufficiency rule was applied. **This set is LEFT AS DRAFT: status draft, NOT stamped, flagged promising.**

Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12_draft, prior cycle: the load-bearing development is that Houthi forces, an Iran-aligned proxy, have moved from "closing in on" to actual island-level closure of the strait (Sept 11, giving them Yemen's entire Red Sea coastline, and separately seized Mayyun (Perim) Island in the strait itself, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island — confirmed by 6+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, etc.) restraint counterweight, logged honestly. Separately, UKMTO's own Warning 133-26 confirms two more vessels struck near Khasab, Oman Sept 10 (one afire); an IRGC claim of a Saildrone strike is single-source (theater) nor the US-casualty clause fires — this is a severity escalation of an already-fired flip-line environment, not a new flip-line event, but is a bigger step than the routine daily grind. **P RE-RATED DOWN to 1/1/14/34/66** (throughout), and verification passed clean — under the runbook's widened delegated authority, neither the size of a move nor the severity of the underlying news is by itself a reason to withhold the stamp.

Sept 11 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-11_draft, prior cycle: the load-bearing development is that this pillar's own "sustained Brent close above \$100" flip-line clause has FIRED. Brent ended Sept 10 at \$100.00 (Reuters, etc.) wire Sept 10, TradingEconomics, Vantage Markets, NAI500 — 4+ independent), and Brent was still ~\$104.36 midday Friday Sept 11, roughly 9% higher on the week despite a ~3% give-back. That is three times the prior cycle's move. *Correction to the prior cycle:* the Sept 10 run logged ~\$101.25 as that Thursday's level — an intraday read, not the close. Second, fuller reporting landed on the Sept 9 shipping wave: Iran attacked 10 vessels (Sept 9) (Reuters, etc.) a US service member, so the confirmed-US-combat-death clause does NOT fire; no further new state was struck, so the widening clause does not fire either. Logged but not used to move P: a single confirmed death, a forecast. **P RE-RATED DOWN to 1/4/20/40/71** — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo 5 → 4, 6mo 22 → 20, 12mo 42 → 40, 36mo 72 → 71. **Auto-stamp decision:** this is an ordinary light daily touch, research capability was fully available, firing is by itself a reason to withhold the stamp. **This set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)." CLARITY Act and Tokenization held flat on independent re-check this cycle.**

Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft, prior cycle: two new dated facts since the Sept 9 baseline. (1) CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC retaliated for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike (Sept 8) (Reuters, etc.) Day 194, corroborating Jordan's own military statement). Jordan is a repeat target (struck previously Aug 30-31), so the widening-to-a-further-new-state clause does NOT fire; CENTCOM/Jordan both confirmed the figure was checked and rejected as uncorroborated against CENTCOM's own no-casualties statement). (2) Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni Red Sea port city of Mocha on Sept 10, closing in on the strait (Reuters, etc.) Jerusalem Post, Cyprus Mail), clearing the sufficiency bar. This is the same Houthi/Yemen actor and theater already priced (not a strike on a further new state), and no strait closure or shipping interdiction

Sept 8 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-08_draft), prior cycle: Iran's SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announced on-record (Iranian state TV, carried by Press TV and Tehran Times), Sept 6-7, that the Iran-Oman corridor agreement would be signed "in the coming days." Corroborated by 8+ independent outlets (Al Jazeera, The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency, Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org) including the precise boundaries, have yet to be announced, and no zone had actually been declared as of this cycle's research cutoff. None of this pillar's flip-line clauses independently fire: DCAS US KIR redirected / 3 disabled / 2 boarded (up from Day 190's 87/3/2 on Sept 3) is a continuation of the already-priced trend, not scored separately. No permanent Iran-Oman corridor deal has been signed. **P RE-**master FINAL NUMBER's equal-weight call band did not flip (Neutral → Neutral) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped.**

Sept 3-5 re-check, held flat: Iran fired a second retaliatory wave Sept 3 on Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhah AB (UAE) — a US official confirmed no US-manned facility was hit and no third night \$100. Two developments logged, NOT used to move P: (1) Reuters shared images/video with four independent weapons experts who concluded the Sept 1 Kheustak wedding-party strike was likely a direct, not accepted responsibility (VP Vance: "extremely skeptical," Sept 4, calling it under investigation), and the confirmation resolves attribution of an ALREADY-PRICED Sept 1-2 event rather than describing it as a terminal — no CENTCOM or independent Western multi-source confirmation as of this research pass, so per the sufficiency rule this single-narrative claim is NOT used to move P. WATCH NEXT CYCLE: Israeli move on Lebanon's Ali al-Taher ridge would trigger a "large-scale attack" on Israel; the IDF took the ridge Sept 3, but no such attack has been confirmed as of this run — a live pending trigger, not a bug in that session, flagged here and not corrected retroactively.

This is a light daily catch-up against the Sept 1 baseline (7/15/32/50/75, auto-stamped) — but it turned into the sharpest single-cycle move since the flip line itself fired Aug 30. **The load-bearing new fact:** direct US strikes on Iranian government oil tankers under a newly reported "tanker for tanker" policy. A US strike on Kuestak, Hormozgan reportedly hit a wedding party (Hormozgan governor's office: 4 of reported as context for Iran's response: coordinated IRGC ballistic-missile and drone strikes Sept 2 on US-linked bases in FOUR countries at once (Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait) — all repeat targets, so the

Still a **dip-watching pillar, not a panic-selling one** — the four-country retaliation hit repeat targets, most projectiles were intercepted, and no US casualty is confirmed. But the trajectory since Aug 30 is not state, or Brent sustaining a close above \$100 would each independently warrant a further, larger cut.

September 3, 2026 update: Alex reviewed this cycle's research (delivered as PDFs Sept 2) and widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy in CLAUDE.md: a call-band flip and the size of a move are single-narrative wedding-casualty claim was correctly kept out of the P move under the sufficiency rule. Nothing about the underlying facts, sourcing, or the sizing of the cut changed — only the stamping the

FULL WEEKLY refresh, September 26, 2026 (score set **2026-09-26_draft2**, draft, awaiting Alex's stamp) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-26_draft committed baseline. **This pillar HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66.**

- Carried forward — what changed in the September 26 light daily touch (2026-09-26_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

Carried forward — what changed in the September 23 light daily touch (2026-09-23_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- Carried forward — what changed in the September 22 light daily touch (2026-09-22_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- Carried forward — the September 19 FULL WEEKLY refresh, for continuity:

FULL WEEKLY refresh, September 19, 2026 (score set **2026-09-19_draft**, DRAFT — awaiting Alex's manual review) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-18_draft committed baseline (1/1/14/33/66), via a full independent

- **Iran's parliament continues moving toward, but has NOT enacted, NPT withdrawal.** A further 130-lawmaker statement (Sept 7-13) urged parliament to begin the legal Article X withdrawal. Foreign Ministry still calls it "still being prepared" (Iran International, Tehran Times, IranWire, APA.az, anews, Militarnyi, IFP News — corroborated but mostly Iran-linked/state-affiliated, the same).
Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66. No window moved; nothing new cleared the sufficiency bar. This is a FULL WEEKLY refresh — full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded.
- **Trump told Axios (Sept 17) he faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime,** ahead of a Tuesday Sept 22 UN General Assembly sideline meeting with six Gulf-state leaders (Axios windows already price maximal active-war uncertainty (1mo/3mo P=1), so it does not clear the bar for a further move.
- **The UN Security Council failed 11-2-2 on Sept 17 to renew its panel of independent experts monitoring reimposed Iran sanctions,** Russia and China vetoing (Somalia/Pakistan abstain vs-E3 legal dispute over the 2025 "snapback" sanctions reimposition — institutional/procedural gridlock, ambiguous direction, not a new sanction or act of war. Does not move P.
- **CORROBORATION UPDATE, reverses last cycle's "not fired/not used" call, but is NOT used to move P:** the Togo-flagged tanker "Trend" strike in the Strait of Hormuz on Sept 17-18 is safe, no confirmed spill; no CENTCOM confirmation or denial was found. This is a continuation of an already-months-long tanker campaign (the US struck three Iranian tankers Sept 1-5), not a new escalation.
- **MARKET PRICE, reported not scored:** Brent ~\$103.21/bbl Sept 18 (down 1.5% day-over-day but still near multi-month highs, having spiked toward \$109 in early September on tanker/energy market volatility).
- **Mixed proxy-front signal, neither clears the bar:** as of Sept 19, Iran has gone a ninth straight day without striking a "host state" (GlobalSecurity.org's OSINT day-by-day tracker) — a mild, mixed signal.
- **Diplomatic wash, not used:** Iranian FM Araghchi said Iran and Oman "agreed a plan" to reopen the Strait (TASS, Caspianpost) but separately clarified (Mehr News, corroborated by Samaa News) that the plan is to "manage" the Strait, not to "reopen" it.
- **Research capability:** full WebSearch available, no degradation. WebFetch to arbitrary domains was blocked in this sandbox (relied on WebSearch summaries, not direct fetches of full UN press releases).

Carried forward — what changed in the September 18 light daily touch (2026-09-18_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 18, 2026 (score set **2026-09-18_draft**, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-17_draft committed baseline (1/1/14/33/66). **This pillar HELD FLAT.**

- **Trump told Axios Sept 17 he faces a "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime,** ahead of a Tuesday UN General Assembly meeting with six Gulf-state leaders (Axios windows already price maximal active-war uncertainty (1mo/3mo P=1), so it does not clear the bar for a further move.
- **Checked and NOT USED — a claim that the IRGC struck a Togo-flagged tanker named "Trend" in the Strait of Hormuz Sept 18.** An initial general search surfaced the claim; a follow-up search found no single claims — no P move on it either way.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66.** No window moved; nothing new cleared the sufficiency bar. AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 17 light daily touch (2026-09-17_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 17, 2026 (score set **2026-09-17_draft**, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-16_draft committed baseline (1/1/14/33/66). **This pillar HELD FLAT.**

- **Re-checked for a new dated development beyond the Sept 9 IAEA referral and the Sept 12-13 NPT-withdrawal statement — found none.** Pezeshkian's public no-nuclear-weapons statement, no pipeline repair timeline, or Hormuz shipping.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/1/14/33/66.** No window moved; nothing new cleared the sufficiency bar. AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 16 light daily touch (2026-09-16_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 16, 2026 (score set **2026-09-16_draft**, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-15_draft committed baseline (1/1/18/38/70). **This pillar RE-RATED DOWN on the day.**

- ★ ★ **NEW — the IAEA Board of Governors voted Sept 9, 2026 to refer Iran's nuclear file to the UN Security Council** — a primary institutional escalation not previously priced by this pillar.
- ★ ★ **NEW — 130 Iranian lawmakers signed a statement Sept 12-13, 2026 calling on parliament to begin the legal process for NPT withdrawal,** with a hardline MP saying an emergency session is needed.
- **Counterweight, logged:** President Pezeshkian publicly reiterated Iran is not seeking nuclear weapons; the Foreign Ministry says the withdrawal bill "is still being prepared" — a real step, not a mere statement.
- **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN, 1/1/18/38/70 → 1/1/14/33/66.** 1mo/3mo held at the floor (no room to move further); 6mo 18 → 14, 12mo 38 → 33, 36mo 70 → 66.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 15 light daily touch (2026-09-15_draft, committed, auto-stamped, held flat), for continuity:

- **The Salalah ministerial remains postponed with no new date** — the fact that drove yesterday's re-rate down, unchanged. Al Jazeera (Sept 14) adds detail already consistent with what was reported: "The decision is a result of consensus."
- **Saudi Arabia's East–West (Petroline) pipeline is still offline** — already priced Sept 12. Saudi energy-ministry sources put the loss at roughly **700,000 barrels a day**; Aramco has not said when it will resume.
- **INTERESTED-PARTY CLAIM, reported not scored:** Bloomberg (Sept 14) reports an *Iranian claim* that a tanker struck mines in the Strait of Hormuz. Uncorroborated by any independent party.
- **MARKET PRICES, reported not scored:** Brent closed above **\$105** and WTI rose toward **\$102** (Sept 14–15), slightly below yesterday's ~\$108 Brent print. Still inside the already-fired "sustained->\$100" clause.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/1/18/38/70.** No window moved; nothing new cleared the sufficiency bar.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 14 light daily touch (2026-09-14_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 14, 2026 (score set **2026-09-14_draft**, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-13_draft committed baseline (3/3/19/39/70).

- ★ ★ **NEW — the Salalah ministerial did not happen. Oman postponed it on Sunday, September 13, with no new date.** PRIMARY: Oman News Agency — "It has been decided to postpone the ministerial meeting." SECONDARY: Reuters, CNN, Gulf News and Malay Mail (Sept 13-14). This is the exact fact yesterday's upward re-rate was built on, and it did not survive the weekend.
- **The problem is Gulf-Arab buy-in, not the calendar. Bahrain explicitly ruled out attending; no GCC state had confirmed participation** before the postponement; and the **UAE had already said it would not attend.**
- **Iran says Saudi Arabia asked for the delay, citing the Yemen war, and calls that a pretext — SINGLE-PARTY SOURCED and NOT used to move P.** This is Iran's MFA spokesman charging Saudi Arabia with destabilizing the region, not contributing to stability and lasting cooperation in our region."
- **FM Araqchi capped the value of what survives: the Iran-Oman understanding "would not mean reopening of the Strait of Hormuz"** (Tehran Times / Mehr News, Sept 13 — Iranian state media). Charts drawn, draft joint statement prepared. That framework survives the postponement — which is why the 1-year window held one point above the Sept 12 level rather than fully retracing.
- **Market reaction — a MARKET PRICE, reported and not scored:** Brent crude pushed past **\$107/bbl (+2.8%, \$107.54 November delivery)** and WTI to **\$102.34 (+2.3%)** on the postponement.
- **Checked and REJECTED as stale:** research this cycle surfaced drone strikes on Oman's Salalah and Duqm ports, which would have been materially escalatory. Those incidents are dated 10/10/2025.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN to 1/1/18/38/70** (from 3/3/19/39/70) — 1mo -2 (the one near-term de-escalation catalyst evaporated with no replacement date) · 3mo -2 (the GCC referral not moved). Ordinary light daily touch, full research access, verification clean — **AUTO-STAMPED** per delegated authority.

Carried forward — the September 13 light daily touch, for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 13, 2026 (score set 2026-09-13_draft, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-12_draft2 full weekly refresh (still draft, awaiting Alex's manual review).

- ★ ★ **NEW — and for the first time since August 6, it cuts the other way: Iran's foreign ministry announced Friday Sept 11 that the foreign ministers of Iran, the six GCC states and 13 other nations will meet in the waterway, built on weeks of Oman-mediated Iran-Oman talks.** This is the first time high-level Iranian and GCC officials have gathered in one place since the war began in February. PRIMARY: Reuters, Sept 11, Dawn Sept 12, Arab News, Oman Observer, The Business Standard, Business Recorder, ARMENPRESS, SBS).
- **Counterweight 1 — incomplete participation:** Bahrain announced Sept 12 that it will not attend the Oman meeting.
- **Counterweight 2 — no outcome expected:** an Iranian official told the Jerusalem Post that no signed Hormuz deal is expected out of Monday's meeting. This is a convening, not a settlement.
- **Counterweight 3 — what is actually being negotiated:** the agenda concerns *managing* transit through a strait Iran still controls, with Tehran weighing a service-fee regime for transiting vessels.
- **Counterweight 4 — the fighting did not pause.** Sept 13: a commercial vessel was attacked near Qeshm Island inside Hormuz, killing one and wounding four (an Iranian official blamed the attack on "terrorists"). The internationally recognised government continued trading strikes over Bab al-Mandeb (Al Jazeera live blog, Sept 13).
- **Market corroboration, reported NOT scored:** Brent gave back 4.24% Friday Sept 11 to ~\$104.26 — the first meaningful downside session since the sustained->\$100 clause fired — attributable to the GCC referral.
- **No flip-line clause fires in either direction.** The two fired downside clauses (direct US strikes on Iran proper, Aug 30; sustained Brent close above \$100, Sept 10-11) both remain fired and do not reset.

- **Score decision: P RE-RATED UP, modestly, to 3/3/19/39/70** (from 1/1/17/37/70) — 1mo/3mo/6mo/12mo +2 each, 36mo held flat at 70. Concentrated on the near windows where the meeting was held (see [this](#)); full research capability, clean verification, and sourcing well above the sufficiency bar. The direction of the move is not itself a reason to withhold the stamp.

Previous entry — FULL WEEKLY refresh, September 12, 2026 (score set 2026-09-12_draft2, still draft) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-12_draft committed baseline.

- ★ ★ **NEW — a third distinct Saudi oil-infrastructure strike this week: Saudi Arabia's East-West Pipeline (Petroline), the kingdom's primary Hormuz-bypass export route, hit by drone** (OilPrice.com); Iraq's PM ordered a probe, dismissed the Maysan operations commander, and closed the Shalamchah border crossing.
- **Attribution caveat:** no group has claimed responsibility; Trump's Dublin remark that Iran is "probably" responsible is a single, hedged, unconfirmed statement, not treated as fact.
- **Neither flip-line clause fires:** the widening clause does NOT fire (Iraq already an active theater since the Sept 1 Erbil strike); the US-casualty clause does NOT fire (none confirmed).
- **Logged, not scored:** the BRICS New Delhi summit's joint declaration (Sept 12) urging "maximum restraint," and Trump's account of a private Houthi restraint signal on Yemen — both count.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN FURTHER, modestly, to 1/1/17/37/70** (from 1/2/18/38/70) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo/6mo/12mo -1 each, 36mo held flat. **This is a FULL W**

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ ★ **NEW — a second global oil chokepoint moves from "under threat" to under adversary-aligned control.** Houthi forces, having seized Mocha Sept 10, captured Dhubab and Murad b. al-Murad, closed the Bab el-Mandeb strait, with fighting continuing for Zuqar Island (Al Jazeera, NBC News, CNBC, NPR, The National, National Herald — 6+ independent). Materially more severe than the Sept 10 base.
- **Logged, honest counterweight:** Saudi Crown Prince MBS twice asked the President for direct US strikes on the Houthis and was refused (intelligence/targeting support offered instead).
- ★ ★ **NEW — UKMTO Warning 133-26 confirms four projectiles struck two more vessels ~4nm west of Khasab, Oman Sept 10, one set afire** (Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill confirmed).
- **Logged, not scored (single-source):** IRGC's own claim of a strike on a US Navy Saildrone near the Strait entrance — no US/CENTCOM confirmation found.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, moderately, to 1/2/18/38/70** (from 1/4/20/40/71) — 1mo held at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -2, 36mo -1. Neither the widening clause (Yemen) nor the underlying news. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new last COMMITTED baseline.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ ★ **NEW — Houthi forces launched a significant ballistic-missile-and-drone attack directly on Saudi Arabian soil Sept 8, hitting Saudi Aramco energy facilities — including the 73 wounded** (NPR, NBC News, Bloomberg, The Times of Israel, US News, Al Jazeera, The Daily Caller, SRN News, plus the Saudi Energy Ministry's own statement). Saudi Arabia is a repeat target.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Brent crude closes above \$100/bbl for a THIRD consecutive session, moving decisively to \$105.71-\$108** — the highest since May 19 (Reuters-linked wires, Bloomberg, ENR, etc.). Not formally called fired.
- ★ ★ **NEW — the IAEA Board of Governors votes 23-3-8 Sept 9 to refer Iran to the UN Security Council over nuclear non-proliferation breaches** — the first such referral in two decades (see [this](#)).
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, larger than the recent 1-point touches, to 1/3/19/38/69** (from 1/5/22/42/72) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -2, 6mo -3, 12mo -4, 36mo -3. Unchanged everywhere — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the new last COMMITTED baseline.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **CENTCOM/Jordan confirm the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at Jordan's Al Azraq (Muwaffaq Salti) air base Sept 9, retaliating for the Sept 8 five-tanker strike.** Jordan's armed forces did not fire; no casualties on either side — the US-casualty clause does not fire either.
- ★ **Iran-aligned Houthi forces seized the Yemeni port of Mocha Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait,** a second global chokepoint distinct from Hormuz (The Media Line).
- **Brent crude traded near/above \$100/bbl for a second straight session** (above \$101 Sept 9, ~\$101.25 Sept 10) — more persistent than Sept 9's intraday cross, but still short of a sustained rise.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/5/22/42/72** (from 1/6/23/43/72) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -1, 12mo -1, 36mo held flat. No flip-line clause independently fired. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 9 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-09_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **CENTCOM confirms US forces destroyed FIVE more Iranian crude oil carriers Sept 8 — M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/T Horizon 1, M/T Riesco (Gulf of Oman), and M/T Derya (Kharg Island)** (GlobalSecurity.org) in addition to CENTCOM's own press release ("US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship"). Both Iranian missile attempts evaded, no US casualties.
- **Brent crude crossed \$100/bbl intraday Sept 9 for the first time since July 24,** trading ~\$100.44 (+2.57%) on U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strike fears (CNBC, ABC News) — the closest that cycle has come.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/6/23/43/72** (from 1/7/24/44/73) — no window moved more than 1 point, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 8 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-08_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **Iran SNSC secretary Mohsen Rezaei announces on-record, Sept 6-7, that Iran will declare a new "restricted zone" from the US Navy's blockade line into the Persian Gulf, sanctioning any breach** (Tehran Times) — clears the sufficiency bar.
- **This is a threat of intent, not yet executed:** Al Jazeera's own Sept 7 explainer says boundaries have yet to be announced; no zone has actually been declared. A parallel claim of an imminent strike.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/7/24/44/73** (from 1/8/25/45/73) — 1mo held flat at the near-floor 1, 3mo -1, 6mo -1, 12mo -1, 36mo held flat. No flip-line clause independently fired. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority:** status committed, stamped_by "Alex (auto-stamped)".

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 6 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-06_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ **CENTCOM's own press release confirmed the Sept 5 tanker strike this pillar had withheld: THREE Iranian tankers struck (M/T Downy, M/T Stark 1, M/T Kylo) in retaliation for an Iranian strike on Sept 4.**
- **Sept 6's single-source IRGC claims of further strikes on 3 more tankers, 3 "US-linked" vessels, and a US naval drone** (Al Jazeera live blog, Euronews) remained US-unconfirmed — no independent confirmation.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 1/8/25/45/73** (from 1/9/27/47/74) — no window moved more than 2 points, master call band unchanged (Neutral → Neutral) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-05_draft2, committed by Alex), for continuity:

- ★ ★ **NEW — Iran fired a second retaliatory wave Sept 3 on Kuwait and UAE, both REPEAT targets.** A US official confirmed no US-manned facility was hit; the widening-to-a-new-state clause did not fire.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Sept 5: the Iranian-flagged NITC tanker STARK 1 reportedly hit by four missiles ~6nm off Kharg Island.** Iran's Tasnim (state media) makes the claim; Iran International (independent) confirms it. CENTCOM has not confirmed or denied it. NOT used to move P per the sufficiency rule — WATCH NEXT CYCLE.
- **Reuters shared images/video with four independent weapons experts corroborating the Sept 1 Kuehstak wedding-strike casualty claim as likely a direct US-munition hit** — resolved.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 1/9/27/47/74.** No flip-line clause independently fired this week (no confirmed new US combat death, no widening to a further new state, Brent short of \$100).
- **Correction:** the same-day earlier 2026-09-05_draft's commit message claimed it was auto-stamped, but config/scores.json's status field was never actually advanced — a bug in that session.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 2 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-02_draft, committed), for continuity:

- ★ ★ **NEW — CENTCOM-confirmed US strikes Sept 1-2 hit nearly 100 targets across Iran, ~50x the scale of the Aug 30 strike.** IRGC air-defense sites, radar, mine-laying capability, command and control.
- ★ ★ **NEW — for the first time in this war, the US struck Iranian government oil tankers directly (engine rooms),** under a newly reported "tanker for tanker" policy.
- ★ ★ **NEW, SINGLE-NARRATIVE-SOURCED at the core fact — a US strike reportedly hit a wedding party in Kuehstak, Hormozgan.** Hormozgan governor's office: 4 of at least 5 dead (independent).
- ★ ★ **NEW — Iran's IRGC retaliated Sept 2 with coordinated strikes on FOUR countries at once: Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, Kuwait.** All four are repeat targets — does NOT independently fire.
- **NEW — Brent rose ~5% Tue Sept 1 (best session in 5 weeks) to ~\$95-96.6; WTI ~\$91-92** — still short of the \$100 flip line. Both sides now on-record threatening larger future action (Trump's tweet).
- **BTC traded at \$76,581.44 (Sept 2)** — down from \$78,038.78 (Sept 1, Bitstamp), a real risk-off move.

- ★ A THIRD Hormuz tanker hit this week, Aug 31, CONFIRMED via UKMTO plus multi-source reporting. The Liberian-flagged VLCC Senegal Prosperity was struck by three unknown projectiles.
- ★ Iran's army claims a drone strike on the UAE's Al Minhad Air Base; the UAE Ministry of Defense DENIES the base was targeted while CONFIRMING a cross-border drone incursion from the Gulf of Oman, Maritime, and Iran International.
- ★ President Trump said on-record Aug 31 he is still weighing further strikes on Iran, calling it "a relatively little war for us" (CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo) — not a de-escalation signal.
- Brent continued higher into Sept 1 (~+2% Tuesday, multiple market-desk reports) — second straight cycle of gains on this news thread; Jordan struck again Aug 30-31 but remained a non-factor.
- BTC traded at \$78,038.78 (Sept 1) — down from \$78,447.16 (Aug 31, Bitstamp).
- Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 7/15/32/50/75 (from 9/17/34/51/75) — 1mo -2, 3mo -2, 6mo -2, 12mo -1, 36mo flat; no single new fact independently fired a fresh flip-line window moved >2 points, master call band unchanged vs. the last stamped set (Mild Bull → Mild Bull), sourcing well above the sufficiency bar.

- ★ **Resumed direct US strike on Iranian territory, Aug 30, CONFIRMED via on-record CENTCOM spokesperson (Capt. Tim Hawkins) plus 20+ independent outlets.** US forces struck two **own pre-declared downside flip line** ("a resumption of direct US strikes on Iran proper... = treat the dip-buy thesis as broken").
- ★ **IRGC retaliatory ballistic-missile strikes on two US-linked Jordan airbases, Aug 30-31, CONFIRMED via Jordan's own military statement.** King Hussein and Al-Azraq airbases targeted.
- **BTC traded at \$78,447.16 (Aug 31)** — up from \$77,666.16 (Aug 29, Bitstamp).
- **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN, front-loaded, to 9/17/34/51/75** (from 14/22/38/54/76) — 1mo -5, 3mo -5, 6mo -4, 12mo -3, 36mo -1, sized to a single resumed-strike-night shock. AUTO

- ★ **"Operation Economic Outcast"** sanctions package, Aug 24, **CONFIRMED** via direct fetch of home.treasury.gov (sb0613, sb0614) and an OFAC recent-actions entry. ~60 entities/instruments added. See [CryptoTimes](https://www.cryptotimes.com), law-firm alerts. **For the first time, digital assets was named a sanctionable sector — 30 crypto addresses (BTC/ETH/TRON) listed.** Real, primary-confirmed, crypto-specific.
- ★ ★ **NEW — Oman's OWN Foreign Ministry co-confirmed a temporary Hormuz corridor, Aug 25, CONFIRMED** via direct fetch of fm.gov.om/en/53722. A genuine upgrade: every prior corridor was "Omani". Still "temporary" — Iran itself said Aug 26 the Strait "remains closed" pending US compliance. No fee terms disclosed.
- **NEW — two more Hormuz "unknown projectile" tanker incidents**, Aug 24 (off Oman, engine-room damage, disabled, no casualties, UKMTO) and Aug 27 (fire onboard, extinguished, crew rescued).
- **NEW — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record briefing, Aug 28:** Iranian sea mines cleared from the shipping lanes; ~1,500 vessels transited since blockade enforcement began.
- **NEW — IMO's six-month casualty count settles at 19-20 dead** across 68-70 incidents — the upper end of the prior 15-19 range.
- **NEW — Trump announced Aug 25 the Strait had been demined**, with a "zero tolerance" policy on new mines (Reuters, Axios, France24, US News) — undercut two days later by the Aug 26 report of a new mine.
- **NEW — first confirmed Hormuz transit-volume uptick of the whole crisis: +30%+ week-over-week** for the week of Aug 17-23 (USNI News/Lloyd's List) — 114 transits vs. 87 the prior week.
- **NEW, FLAGGED AND NOT USED — an IRGC spokesman's Aug 26 claim of an Iran-Oman Hormuz revenue-sharing agreement** (Sepah News, Iranian state military source) is unconfirmed.
- **Brent eased for a SECOND straight week:** ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28), down from ~\$93-95 (Aug 20-21) — moving further from the \$100 flip line.
- **No new confirmed US combat death Aug 22-29;** no new US/CENTCOM strikes found (GlobalSecurity Day-181 tracker, 28th consecutive clean night).
- **BTC closed at \$77,666.16 (Aug 29)** — up modestly from \$77,266.84 (Aug 22, Bitstamp).

- **Aug 17/18/20 drafts (never delivered):** held flat, then cut to 17/25/38/54/76, then cut further to 16/24/38/54/76 on the lapsed MoU window and the UAE missile claim (framed as a "novel escalation")
- **Aug 21 (partially delivered, then abandoned):** a session began delivering the Aug 20 draft's numbers but updated only 2 of 6 reports and never ran render/selfcheck/archive/commit — treat as a redaction
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — a fatal strike in the Hormuz tanker-attack campaign,** Aug 17-18: bulker Minoan Dignity's chief engineer killed, 7+ independent sources. That draft first (wrongly) framed the strike as a "novel escalation"
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — the first Iranian vessel seizure since June 22,** the tanker Amara, boarded near Qeshm Island Aug 17, still detained Aug 19. Confirmed accurate on adversarial review
- ★ **Aug 22 morning draft — CORRECTION: the UAE missile claim is NOT the first direct attack on the UAE** as prior drafts framed it; UAE was hit in April and at Fujairah May 4. The "novel escalation" framing was dropped
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle (draft2) — casualty toll re-verified as a range, not a point figure.** Second dedicated adversarial pass cross-checked Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox (and **Hormuz-specific trackers**). This softens the morning draft's "roughly the 18th" framing, which was more precise than the sources support; corrected everywhere in this report.
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle (draft2) — the UAE missile claim reconciles to one episode, not two.** Aug 19-dated reporting (Washington Post, NBC News, Haaretz, The Week, EgyptToday) described the strike as a "novel escalation" above the baseline.
- **★ NEW this cycle (draft2) — no new kinetic incident found Aug 19-22** on independent re-checking; CENTCOM's blockade tally continues climbing incrementally (68 vessels redirected, vs. 60 in the Aug 20 draft)
- **No new US/CENTCOM strikes since Aug 1; sanctions remain mostly rhetoric** (one narrow OFAC-adjacent Hezbollah designation Aug 22, not the promised Iran-economy package); Iran's "no strikes" stance remains unchanged
- **BTC closed at \$77,169.40 (Aug 22)** — +7.4% vs. the Aug 20 close of \$71,882.92, a further move against the direction of this pillar's own evidence — logged as an honesty check (The Claimant's BTC price is not a "novel escalation")
- **Score decision (draft2):** versus the Aug 16 committed baseline: 1mo 20 → **14** · 3mo 28 → **22** · 6mo 41 → **38** · 12mo 56 → **54** · 36mo 77 → **76** — unchanged from the Aug 22 morning draft (see the full reasoning).

- **September 19 FULL WEEKLY refresh (this cycle):** Iran International, Tehran Times, IranWire, APA.az, anews, Militarny, IFP News (Sept 7-13) — NPT-withdrawal process: 130-lawmaker statement, Parliament President Rouhani, Jerusalem Post, Politico/Political Wire, Israel National News, Common Dreams, Breitbart, CBN News (Sept 17-18) — Trump's "big decision"/"annihilate" remark and the Sept 22 UN General Assembly sideline meeting with Netanyahu (abstaining) failing to renew the Iran-sanctions monitoring panel - IRNA (primary, via GlobalSecurity.org reprint), The Hill, Bernama, IranWire, TFTC, Parapolitika, Rio Times (Sept 17-18) — IRGC's own statement confirming the strike ("state") and Times of Israel liveblog (Sept 19, Houthi-linked air-raid alert on Riyadh) — mixed proxy-front signal - TASS, Caspiantpost, Mehr News, Samaa — FM Araghchi's Iran-Oman Strait "agreed a plan" claim and its corroboration
- **September 18 light daily touch (prior cycle):** Axios — original interview, Trump's "big decision" on whether to "annihilate" the Iranian regime (Sept 17, primary reporting of a direct quote) · Times of Israel, Politico Wire — report on up for corroboration of a claimed IRGC strike on a Togo-flagged tanker named "Trend" in the Strait of Hormuz, Sept 18 — no named outlet or primary (CENTCOM/IRGC) source found that cycle; claim NOT corroborated
- **September 14 LIGHT DAILY touch: Oman News Agency (ONA) — state news agency statement, Sunday Sept 13, 2026: the Salalah regional meeting is "postponed to a later date ... in order to create conditions for a meeting"** (Sept 13) · The Washington Post, "Oman postpones regional talks on Strait of Hormuz" (Sept 13) · CNN, "Iran-Gulf talks without US participation on reopening the Strait of Hormuz postponed, Omani officials *reported not scored* — and for Brent \$107.54 / WTI \$102.34, *market prices*" · Malay Mail, "Oman postpones Iran-Gulf talks on Strait of Hormuz" (Sept 14) · Tehran Times / Mehr News, "FM Araghchi: Oman understanding of the situation *statement · Checked and excluded as stale:* Seatrade Maritime, Argus Media, Times of Israel and Gulf News reporting on drone strikes at Salalah and Duqm ports — those are dated March 13/11, 2026, and are not particularly relevant
- **September 13 LIGHT DAILY touch (prior cycle):** Iranian Ministry of Foreign Affairs — announcement (Friday Sept 11) that Iran will meet the GCC foreign ministers and Iraq in Salalah, Oman on Monday Sept 14 to discuss the situation in the Gulf states on Monday," Sept 11 · Dawn, "Tehran agrees to engage Gulf states over Hormuz future," Sept 12 · Arab News · Oman Observer, "Salalah to host Iran-GCC Hormuz talks on Monday" · The Business Standard · Bloomberg

- FULL WEEKLY REFRESH (prior cycle)**: Saudi Arabia's Ministry of Foreign Affairs — official statement confirming drone strikes on East-West Pipeline (Tetrahedron) pumping stations near Riyadh/Medina, corroborating outlets) — probe of the Maysan operations command, commander dismissed, Shalamchah border crossing closed · President Trump's on-record Dublin remarks — Iran "probably" responsible (single, hedged), urging "exercising maximum restraint" · Euronews, Al Jazeera, NBC News, NPR, Eurasia Review, Middle East Eye, ZeroHedge — re-verification that the Mayyun (Perim) Island/Bab al-Mandeb seizure still holds · TradingEconomics
 - September 12 light daily catch-up (prior, this morning)**: Al Jazeera ("Can the Houthis close the Red Sea after seizing the Yemen coast?," Sept 11) — Houthi capture of the entire Red Sea coastline · NBC News, CNBC refused · UKMTO Warning 133-26 (1910 UTC Sept 10, official) — four projectiles struck two vessels near Khasab, Oman, one afire · Gulf News, Maritime Executive, The Hill — corroborating reporting on the Khasabs US confirmation found · local run.py quant refresh — BTC \$76,745.60 (Sept 13) vs. \$77,289.66 (Sept 12) vs. \$77,063.25 (Sept 11) vs. \$77,993.99 (Sept 10).
 - September 11 light daily catch-up**: Rigzone (Bloomberg wire, Sept 10) — Brent ended Thursday up more than 6% above \$107 after trading above \$108 intraday, highest in nearly four months; WTI closed above \$102 Markets, NA500 (Sept 10) — corroborating Brent above \$100-102 on Hormuz strike risk · Reuters wire via U.S. News, RTE, Foreign Policy, The Hill (Sept 9) — Iran attacked 10 vessels near Hormuz (2 US-linked ships surfaced in search summaries (flagged as a degraded pull, not used alone to move P)).
 - September 10 light daily catch-up**: Al Jazeera (Sept 9), MiGFlug, GlobalSecurity.org (Iran War 2026 Day 194) — corroborating reporting on Jordan's own military statement confirming the IRGC fired 20 ballistic missiles at the Houthi seizure of the Yemeni port of Mocha, Sept 10, closing in on control of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait · CNBC — Brent above \$101 Wednesday Sept 9, first time since May · TradingEconomics — Brent ~\$101.25 Tuesday workflow — BTC \$77,993.99 (Sept 10) vs. \$79,052.40 (Sept 9) vs. \$78,435.62 (Sept 8).
 - September 9 light daily catch-up**: CENTCOM (centcom.mil) — official press release, "US Destroys 5 IRGC Tankers After Iran Targets Another American Warship" (Sept 8, primary source): M/T Kaviz, M/T Charminar, M/V Navy warship, both evaded · CNBC — "Brent crude tops \$100 as U.S.-Iran tit-for-tat strikes stoke oil supply worries" (Sept 9) · ABC News — corroborating Brent ~\$100.44 intraday, +2.57% · standing DoD casualty record.
 - September 8 light daily catch-up**: Press TV, Tehran Times (Iranian state media) — Mohsen Rezaei's (SNSC secretary) on-record statement, Sept 6-7, announcing intent to declare a "restricted zone" from the US Navy boundaries not yet announced), The Hill, RTE, Anadolu Agency (aa.com.tr), Newsbytes, WFLA/Nexstar, GlobalSecurity.org — corroborating reporting on the same Rezaei statement · GlobalSecurity.org — Iran War 2026 ~\$97.29/bbl Sept 7 close · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$78,435.62 (Sept 8) vs. \$79,090.41 (Sept 7) vs. \$80,338.98 (Sept 6).
 - September 6 light daily catch-up**: CENTCOM (centcom.mil) — official press release, "CENTCOM Destroys 3 IRGC Oil Tankers After Iran Targets 2 U.S. Navy Warships" (Sept 5, primary source) · Al Arabiya English, J. Al Jazeera live blog ("Iran war live: IRGC claims attacks on 3 oil tankers and 3 US-linked ships," Sept 6) and Euronews (Sept 6, Iranian forces targeting a US naval drone) — Iran's own Sept 6 follow-on claims, not US-CO Saturday Sept 6, no new print · GitHub Actions data-fetch workflow — BTC \$79,929.30 (Sept 6) vs. \$79,646.11 (Sept 5).
 - September 3-5 re-check**: GlobalSecurity — Iran War 2026 Day 188-189 updates (Sept 3-4): Iran's second retaliatory wave hit Ahmed al-Jaber AB (Kuwait) and Al Minhad AB (UAE), both repeat targets; a US official confirmed analysis of images/video verified by Reuters, concluding the Sept 1 Kuhestak wedding strike was likely a direct hit by a US munition (JSOW-type glide-bomb fragments); VP Vance's "extremely skeptical" comment, Sept 5, moved on Lebanon's Ali al-Tajer ridge would trigger a "large-scale attack" on Israel; IDF took the ridge Sept 3, no such attack confirmed as of this run.
 - September 2 light daily catch-up — CENTCOM-confirmed strikes plus multi-source reporting on the retaliation**: Axios, CNBC, CNN, Bloomberg, UPI — corroborating reporting on the CENTCOM-confirmed US strategy "tanker for tanker" policy · Al Jazeera, CBS News, Yahoo, UPI — reporting on the Kuhestak, Hormozgan wedding-strike casualty claim (Hormozgan governor's office source; CENTCOM's Cmdr. Tim Hawkins told CBS News coordinated strikes on Jordan, Bahrain, Iraq, and Kuwait, interception rates, and the absence of a confirmed new US combat death · CNBC — Trump's "significantly larger response" threat and an unnamed senior Iranian official.
 - September 1 light daily catch-up — UKMTO log plus multi-source reporting**: UKMTO — Senegal Prosperity incident log, Aug 31 (VLCC struck by three unknown projectiles ~17nm NE of Khasab, Oman; port side, damaged) · the UAE Ministry of Defense's on-record denial of the target claim plus confirmation of an intercepted Iranian drone over UAE territorial waters · CBS News, Breitbart, Yahoo — Trump's on-record Aug 31 remarks that he "didn't want to see another ship sink" · \$78,447.16 (Aug 31).
 - August 31 light daily catch-up — on-record statement plus multi-source reporting**: CENTCOM spokesperson Capt. Tim Hawkins (on the record, via Bloomberg/CNBC/NBC/Newsweek) — confirms the Aug 30 strike on Iranian launchers near Strait of Hormuz" (Aug 30) · NBC News — "U.S. forces strike Iranian rocket launchers... first military action in weeks" (Aug 30) · Newsweek — "US Forces Strike Iranian Military as Sea Mines Approach Suez Canal" airbases, Jordan (Aug 31) · Jordan's military statement (via Fox News, HNGN) — 8 missiles intercepted · Al Jazeera — "Iran targets Jordan after first US attack in a month" (Aug 31) · Reuters/CNBC — renewed exchange between the two sides." · Bitstamp — BTC \$77,666.16 (Aug 29 close) vs. \$77,266.84 (Aug 22).
 - August 29 full weekly refresh — direct primary-source adversarial fetches**: home.treasury.gov — press releases sb0613 ("Treasury Launches Unprecedented Campaign Against Iranian Regime on Economic D-Demanding Digital Assets Sector designation") · law-firm trade-compliance client alerts (Aug 24-25) · fm.gov.om/en/53722 — Oman's own Foreign Ministry joint statement, Aug 25, confirming a temporary Hormuz corridor and a "temporary" ban on shipping through the Strait.
 - August 29 full weekly refresh — reporting and data**: UPI, The National, Washington Times, The Hill, RedState, IranWire (Aug 28) — CENTCOM commander Adm. Brad Cooper's on-record mine-clearing/blockade breaking update, +30%/+ week-over-week (114 vs. 87 transits, week of Aug 17-23) · Reuters (via Yahoo, France24, Axios, US News, Investing.com) — Trump's Aug 25 Strait-of-Hormuz demining/zero-tolerance statement · UKMTMO — Omani revenue-sharing claim, checked against and NOT confirmed by Oman's Foreign Ministry · TradingEconomics, various (Aug 25-28) — Brent ~\$88.24 (Aug 25) → ~\$89.13-89.3 (Aug 27) → ~\$88.29-90.55 (Aug 28) confirmed killed Jul 18-19, already in the standing total, not a new Aug 22-29 death · Bitstamp — BTC \$77,666.16 (Aug 29 close) vs. \$77,266.84 (Aug 22).
 - August 28 daily catch-up draft (2026-08-28_draft) — never rendered, self-checked, archived, or committed; treated as abandoned/superseded, findings independently re-verified fresh above**: UKMTO-sources (via Yahoo, France24, Axios, US News, Investing.com) — Trump's Aug 25 Strait-of-Hormuz demining/zero-tolerance statement · Bloomberg, Yahoo Finance, Insurance Journal, Daily Sabah (all Aug 26) — IRGC spokespeople ~\$87.65-89/bbl (Aug 27), easing from the Aug 20-21 range.
 - August 22 draft2 — second dedicated adversarial-verification pass (same-day full weekly refresh, independent of the morning fact-check below)**: Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" infobox — cumulative toll broader Middle East, not Hormuz cleanly (may include the separate Aug 12 Bab al-Mandeb/Houthi strike, 6 killed per Al Jazeera) — NET FINDING: honest range 15-19 (17-18 by the most Hormuz-specific trackers), not 15-19 second incident, reconciled on cross-reference to the same Aug 18 episode already in the draft baseline (CBS/CNN/Al Jazeera) · independent re-check for Aug 19-22 vessel strikes/seizures/incidents — none found beyond the Aug 18 episode.
 - August 22 morning draft — adversarial fact-check (dedicated, independent of the research pass below)**: Riviera, UN News, and Wikipedia's "2026 Strait of Hormuz crisis" tracker — REFUTES this report's own internal June 2026 Hormuz strike, cumulative toll 12-17 deaths across ~65 attacks per multiple outlets (see draft2 entry above for this cycle's further re-verification, which settles on a 15-19 range) · Al Jazeera, Bloomberg, Gulf News (wounded, oil-loading disrupted), both predating and contradicting the "novel escalation vector" framing carried since Aug 20.
 - August 20-22 verification (four parallel primary-source research passes)**: UKMTO, Maritime Executive, Windward, Hellenic Shipping News, Riviera, Safety4Sea, Splash247 (Aug 17-18) — bulkier Minoan Dignity struck regime, still detained Aug 19 · GlobalSecurity.org Day-175 tracker — no new US/CENTCOM strikes on Iran since the Aug 1 stand-down · home.treasury.gov / Bessent public statements (Aug 20-22) — sanctions package (Aug 22) — Iran will allow Iraqi oil tankers through the Strait · Bitstamp — BTC \$77,266.84 (Aug 22 close, this cycle) vs. \$71,882.92 (Aug 20).
 - August 18-20 verification**: Bloomberg, CNN, and CP24 (all Aug 18) — UAE reports two Iranian ballistic missiles fired at its territory, one landing in territorial waters; Iran's foreign ministry denies involvement, calls it a pirate attack, Strait, engine damage, one crew injury · CBS and CNN (Aug 19) — Trump threatens "the most crushing economic operation ever taken against any country" (new sanctions rhetoric); same-day, Trump softens "no time to negotiate" · strikes on US assets in Europe (Bulgaria airspace, Cyprus, fiber cables). Single-source, uncorroborated by any second outlet this cycle; logged as a watch item, explicitly NOT used to move any P · Bitstamp — BTC \$71,882.92 (Aug 20).
 - August 17-18 draft sources (never delivered as a report; independently re-verified this cycle against the above and found accurate)**: CBS News — live desk, "Trump threatens to bomb Oman with Iran war stocks" ~130/day originally carried; Brent \$90.87) · CNN — "Deadline to reach US-Iran deal expires, Trump threatens Oman" (Aug 17) · Al Jazeera — live blog, MoU expiry coverage (Aug 17) · TradingEconomics — Brent \$90.87 (Aug 17).
 - August 16 light daily check**: Al Jazeera — "UAE accuses Iran of attacks on two ADNOC vessels in Strait of Hormuz" (Aug 14) · CBS News — live desk, third ADNOC vessel hit Aug 15 (UKMTO), Vance remarks on en route.
 - August 14 light daily check**: US News — "Iran Says Deal on Strait of Hormuz Is Close but Not Enough to Open the Waterway" · NBC News — "Iran sets out steep demands for reopening Hormuz despite hopes Oman may ease tensions" · Bloomberg — "Oil Holds Drop as Hormuz Deal Elusive While Ship Attacks Persist" (Aug 13) — all confirm the same stalled-on-compensation dispute, hardened not resolved; a live tracker (straits.live) shows day 166 of the standoff.
 - August 13 light daily check**: CNN — Hormuz agreement analysis, re-checked · NPR — Iran-Oman agreement terms, re-checked · Al Jazeera — "Iran deliberates Hormuz arrangement amid uncertain prospects with US".
 - August 11 light daily check**: NBC News, Al Jazeera, CBC, NPR, UPI, and Al Bawaba — six independent outlets corroborating the Aug 9 Houthi drone strike on Saudi Aramco's Jazan refinery, Saudi energy ministry statement.
 - August 10 light daily check**: GlobalSecurity.org — day-by-day Iran war tracker, re-checked, no new entry since Aug 5 · Euronews and Al Jazeera — Hormuz coverage archives, re-checked, no new dated item · Wikipedia — Iran War 2026.
 - August 9 light daily check**: Reuters — "Iran says deal on Strait of Hormuz is close but not enough to open the waterway," wire-distributed via Investing.com, US News, Jakarta Post, Japan Times, Haaretz, and Rapples.
 - August 8 full-weekly additions**: Bloomberg / UANI — Hormuz incident tracking, 65 cumulative incidents (Jul 31 - Aug 5) · globalsecurity.org — Gaslog Shanghai and Minoan Pioneer incident detail · CNN — "Iranian-backed ships in Strait of Hormuz" Fortune — "Iran says agreement on Hormuz shipping reached with Oman" (Aug 7) and "Iran says it has a deal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz—and shipowners are outraged by its plan to charge fees" (Aug 6) · NPR — Israeli Ships in Strait of Hormuz" (Aug 6) · CNBC — US official rejects one-sided fee/ban terms (Aug 6).
 - August 7 additions**: Iranian FM spokesman Baghaei (via globalsecurity.org/IRNA relay) — joint statement "in final stage," under review pending no third-party obstruction · Pravda USA (AP-sourced wire relay) — "Ship seized in Persian Gulf" development position (Aug 6-7) · ABC News live updates — Trump comments on US munitions stockpile.
 - August 6 additions**: IRNA (via Bloomberg/Military.com relay) — Deputy FM Gharibabadhi's "understanding in principle" statement · Bloomberg — "Iran Says Deal With Oman on Strait of Hormuz Agreed in Principle" (Aug 5) and "Hormuz deal 'close': what's the latest on each side's positions?" (Aug 6) · Euronews — "Iran and Oman agree route for ships" (Aug 5) · Fortune — "Iran says it has a deal to reopen the Strait of Hormuz—and shipowners are outraged by its plan to charge fees" (Aug 6) · Fast Company / DOL —

- **Diplomacy:** Al Jazeera — talks status, no formal MoU withdrawal, Khamenei burial (July 10) · Al Jazeera — mediators urge MoU compliance (July 9) · CNN live — Trump on talks / “Cease Fire is OVER”, Qatari team to — Doha outcomes (July 2).
- **The oil waiver:** CBS — GL X1 waiver rescission (July 7) · Axios — waiver revocation (July 7) · The Hill — sanctions detail (July 7).
- **The prices:** Fortune — Brent ~\$76.00–76.80 (July 10) · Kitco/Reuters — oil fell as markets weigh strikes (July 9) · Sunday Guardian — Brent ~\$76 / WTI <\$72 (July 10; weaker source) · CNBC — Brent \$78.02 / WTI \$~50% of pre-war vs ~92% drop — transponders off; pre-attack throughput figures are from the unofficial straits.live tracker — single-source) · CoinDesk — BTC steady above \$62K (July 9) · CoinDesk — BTC to ~\$64K
- **The odds (sentiment only, not fact):** Blockchain.News — invasion odds 11.5% → 14.5% (~July 8 print) · Blockchain.News — Hormuz-normal-by-July odds collapse to 4.5% (403 at retrieval; cited via search) · Direct P withdrawal by Jul 31” reads (~5–7%, dated ~Jul 3–5) and “final deal by Dec 31” (35.5% last verified Jul 8) are stale and not re-verified this week.